AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Armory

Offensive Security, Pentesting & Bug Bounty Tools

42	392,346	95%	36
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: The professional offensive toolkit for authorized engagements, red-team exercises and training labs — the weapons every pentester reaches for first.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

42	40	392,346	36	6,601	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: The professional offensive toolkit for authorized engagements, red-team exercises and training labs — the weapons every pentester reaches for first.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Armory realm of offensive security, pentesting, and bug bounty tools holds 42 curated entries, with 95% hosted on GitHub and an oldest entry dating to September 2010, establishing a mature, long-standing ecosystem. Adoption is heavily concentrated in its top five tools, which account for over 40% of the combined 392,346 total stars, with Metasploit Framework and sqlmap leading at 39.2k and 38.7k stars respectively. 36 of the 42 tools received code pushes in 2026, indicating active maintenance for the vast majority of the curated set. A notable takeaway is the presence of four quiet classics—Ghauri, tplmap, JoomScan, and ACSTIS—that have not seen 2026 pushes, suggesting a subset of legacy tools that remain in the collection despite reduced recent development. The license mix is split, with 13 tools using GPL, 12 with other or no licenses, and 9 under MIT, reflecting varied open-source governance across the curated toolset.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

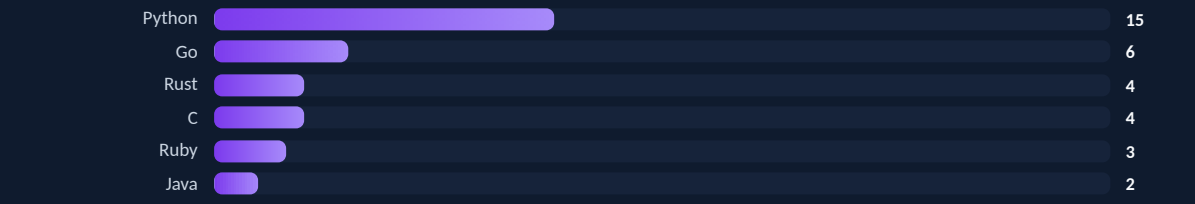
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

WhatWeb	2010-09-30
Metasploit Framework	2011-08-30
sqlmap	2012-06-26
WPScan	2012-07-11
ettercap	2012-07-14

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

2mny Website Vulnerability Scanner	2026-10
h5i	2026-03
NetExec	2023-09
BloodHound	2023-08
Ghauri	2022-10

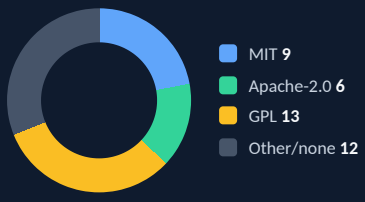
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
6	13	15	6

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

Ghauri, tplmap, JoomScan, ACSTIS

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 Metasploit Framework

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

github.com/rapid7/metasploit-framework

star weight vs realm #1



★ 39.2k	GITHUB STARS
14,998	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2011	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Ruby	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Metasploit Framework"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the world's most-used pentest framework; thousands of validated modules for exploitation, post-engagement evidence gathering and reporting in authorized tests.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by professional penetration testers and red teams in authorized engagements; the open-source counterpart to commercial exploitation platforms like Core Impact and Cobalt Strike.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



15	14,998	606	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 sqlmap

github.com/sqlmapproject/sqlmap

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 38.7k	GITHUB STARS
6,403	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Automatic SQL injection and database takeover tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the definitive SQL injection detection and exploitation tool for authorized web application testing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by penetration testers everywhere for SQL injection proof; the definitive free SQLi automation tool with no real commercial equal.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	6,403	31	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 Nuclei

github.com/projectdiscovery/nuclei

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 32.1k	GITHUB STARS
3,966	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Nuclei is a fast, customizable vulnerability scanner powered by the global security community and built on a simple YAML-based DSL, enabling collaboration to tackle trending vulnerabilities on the internet. It helps you "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

template-driven vulnerability scanner; the huge community template corpus gives it detection breadth no single scanner matches.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters and enterprise security teams alike for template-driven scanning at scale; a free staple that rivals paid web-scanning engines for public attack-surface checks.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



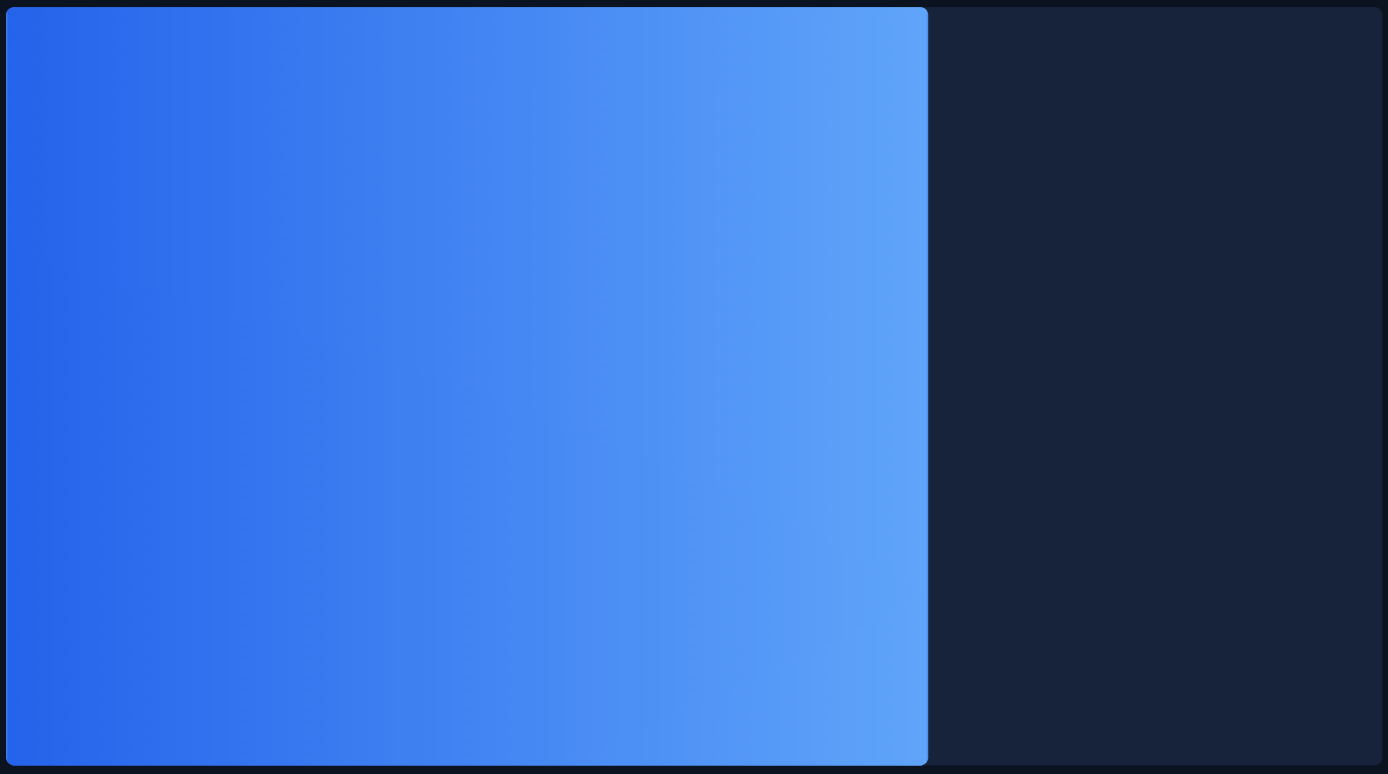
6	3,966	140	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 masscan

github.com/robertdavidgraham/masscan

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 26.1k	GITHUB STARS
3,247	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"TCP port scanner, spews SYN packets asynchronously, scanning entire Internet in under 5 minutes."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the fastest TCP port scanner on earth; scan the whole internet in minutes — on networks you're authorized to test.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers and recon teams for internet-scale port discovery.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



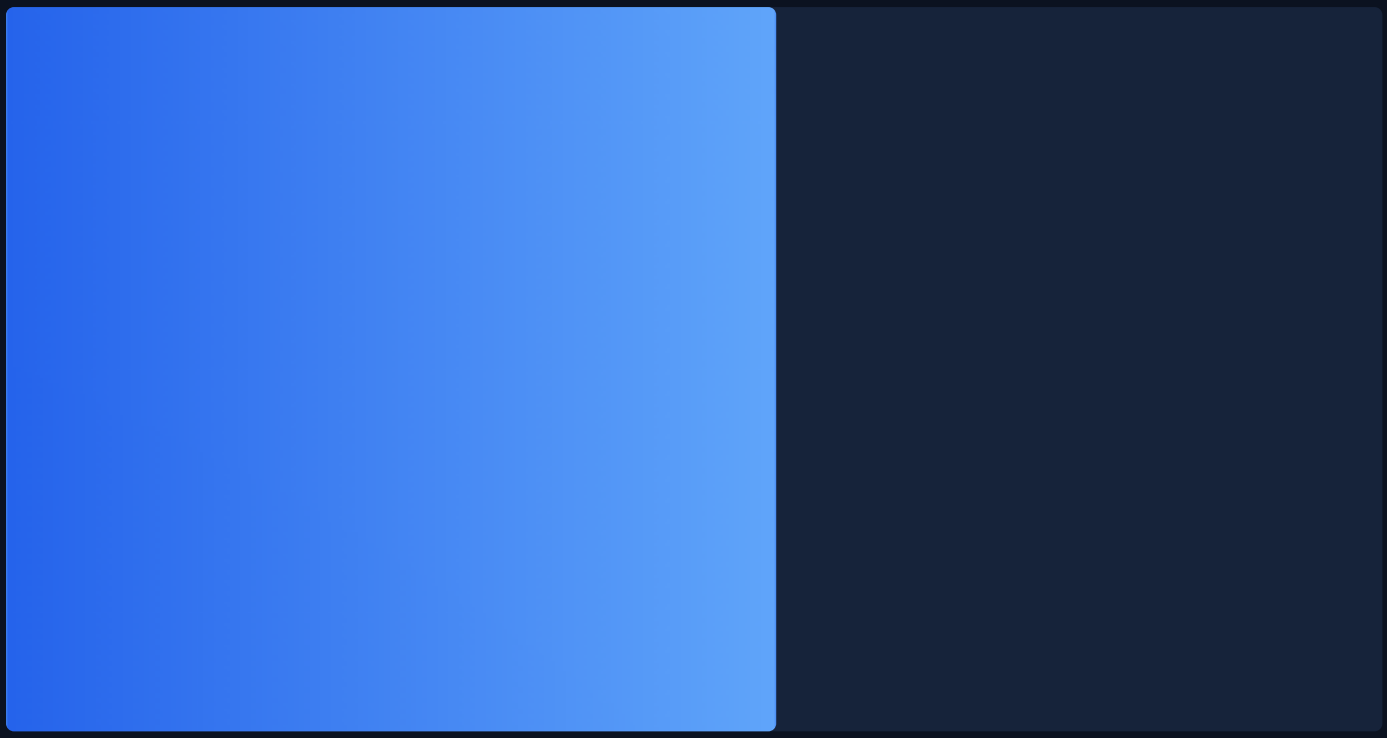
13	3,247	414	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 MobSF

github.com/MobSF/Mobile-Security-Framework-MobSF

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 22k	GITHUB STARS
3,788	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Mobile Security Framework (MobSF) is an automated, all-in-one mobile application (Android/iOS/Windows) pen-testing, malware analysis and security assessment framework capable of performing static and dynamic analysis."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

all-in-one mobile app security: static + dynamic analysis for Android/iOS in a single pipeline.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile app security testers for static and dynamic analysis; the open-source alternative to commercial mobile app testing suites.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



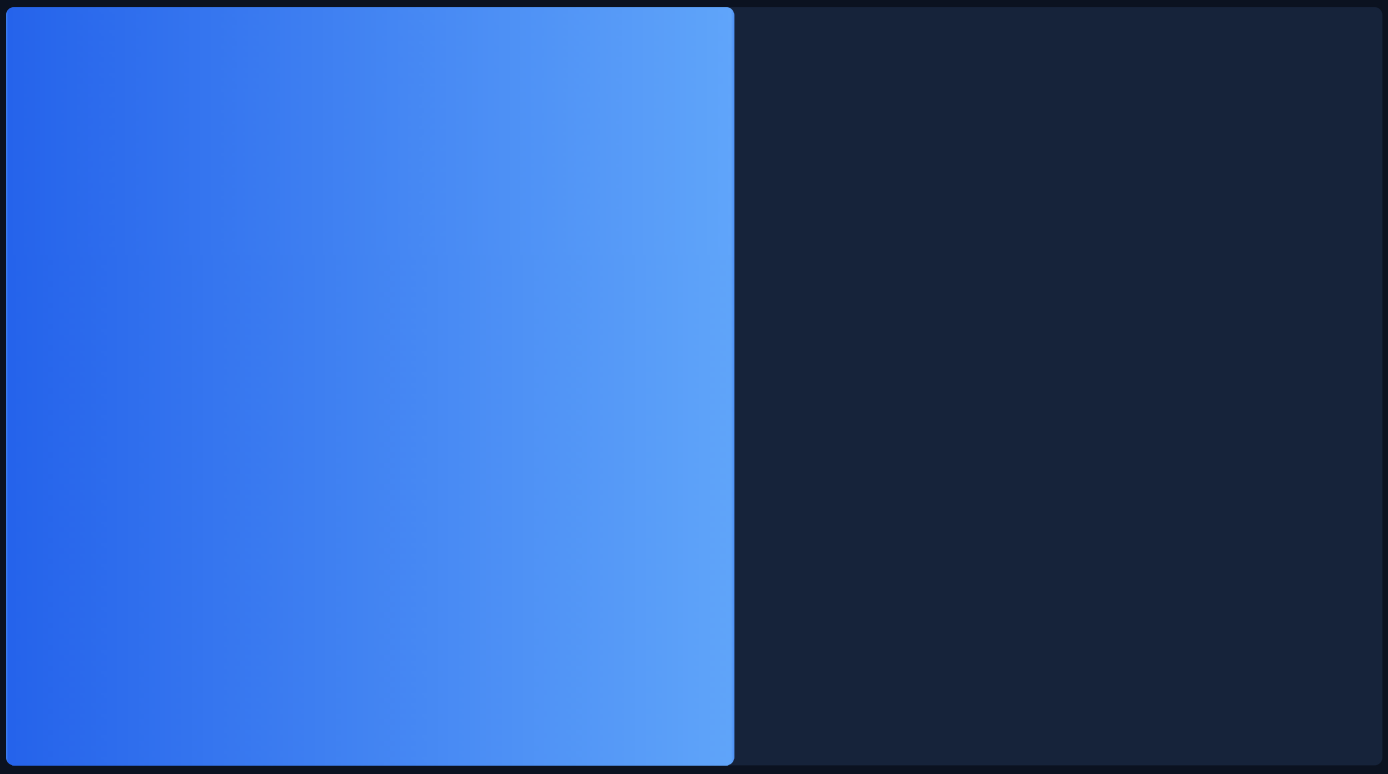
11	3,788	16	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 RustScan

github.com/bee-san/RustScan

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 20.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,396	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🤖 The Modern Port Scanner 🤖"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

modern Rust port scanner that finds open ports in seconds and pipes them straight into Nmap.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters and sysadmins for fast port discovery with Nmap piping; a modern free alternative to legacy scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6	1,396	18	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 Bettercap

github.com/bettercap/bettercap

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 20.1k	GITHUB STARS
1,727	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The Swiss Army knife for 802.11, BLE, HID, CAN-bus, IPv4 and IPv6 networks reconnaissance and MITM attacks."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Swiss-army knife for authorized network assessments: ARP/DNS spoofing, MITM proxies, WiFi and BLE modules.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network penetration testers for authorized MITM analysis; the modern successor to Ettercap in most toolkits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8	1,727	44	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 Impacket

github.com/fortra/impacket

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 16.2k	GITHUB STARS
3,972	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Impacket is a collection of Python classes for working with network protocols."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the standard Python library for low-level Windows protocol work (SMB, LDAP, Kerberos); powers wmiexec/secretsdump-class tooling and AD assessments.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by red teamers and AD security researchers; the Python underpinning of countless offensive and defensive toolkits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	3,972	326	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 OWASP ZAP

github.com/zaproxy/zaproxy

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 15.9k	GITHUB STARS
2,667	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The ZAP by Checkmarx Core project"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the open-source intercepting proxy and scanner — a full free Burp alternative with CI/CD integration and a big add-on ecosystem.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters, QA teams and bug bounty beginners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	2,667	866	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 THC-Hydra

github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 12.4k	GITHUB STARS
2,683	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"hydra"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic parallelized login cracker for 50+ protocols; password audits only on systems you own or are paid to test.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters for authorized login audits across 50+ protocols; the classic parallelized cracker with no commercial equal.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12	2,683	49	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 Red-Teaming-Toolkit

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/infosecn1nja/Red-Teaming-Toolkit

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.8k	GITHUB STARS
2,378	FORKS
2026-05	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"This repository contains cutting-edge open-source security tools (OST) for a red teamer and threat hunter."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

curated index of adversary-emulation and red-team tradecraft resources.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by red teamers planning their tooling stack. (curated list)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8	2,378	10	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 Nikto

github.com/sullo/nikto

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,467	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Perl	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Nikto web server scanner"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

venerable web-server scanner; noisy but thorough on server misconfigurations and default files.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web server auditors for two decades; the venerable free complement to commercial web scanners' misconfiguration checks.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



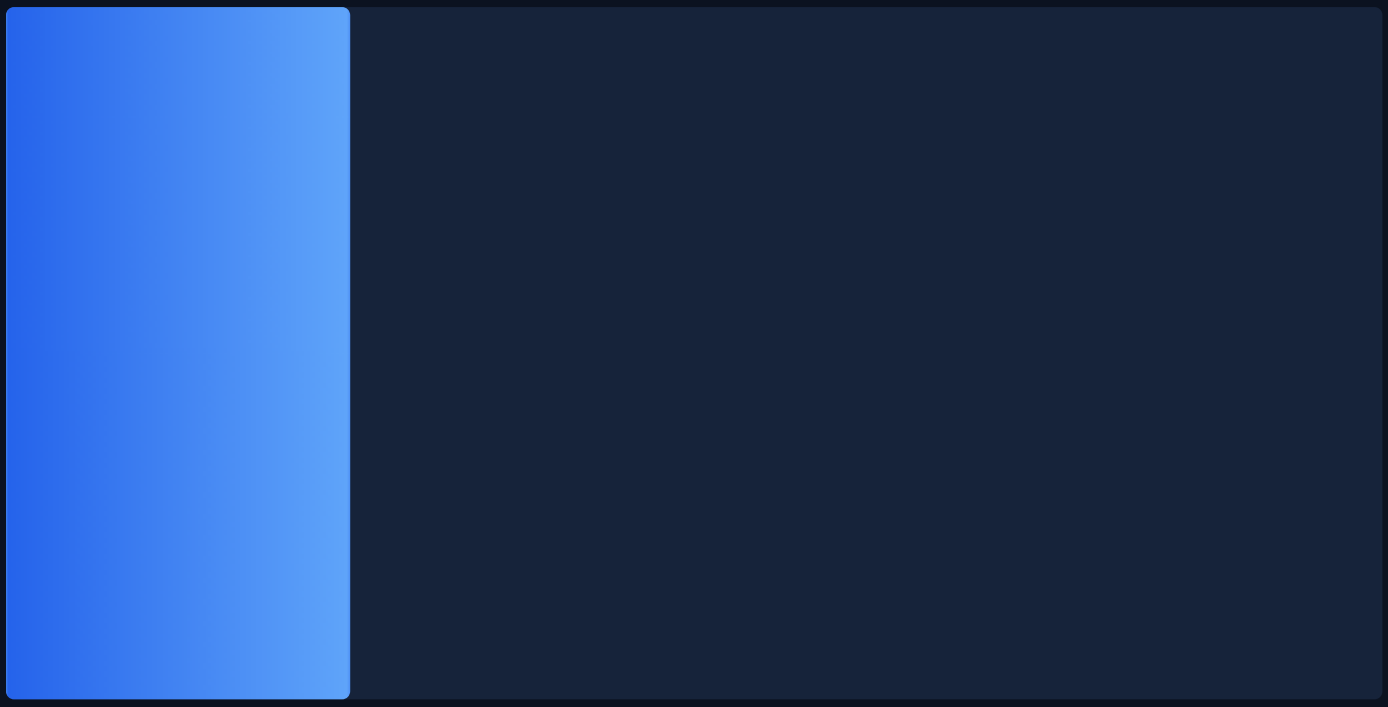
14	1,467	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

13 WPScan

github.com/wpscanteam/wpscan

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,348	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Ruby	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WPScan WordPress security scanner. Written for security professionals and blog maintainers to test the security of their WordPress websites. Contact us via contact@wpscan.com"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

black-box WordPress scanner: plugin/theme enumeration and version-based vuln lookups.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by WordPress security auditors and managed-service providers; the standard black-box WordPress scanner, free alternative to paid WP security suites. (free for non-commercial use)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	1,348	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

14 objection

github.com/sensepost/objection

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.4k	GITHUB STARS
1,003	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“ 📱 *objection - runtime mobile exploration*”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Frida-powered runtime exploration toolkit for mobile apps — inspect and manipulate iOS/Android at runtime.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile pentesters for runtime exploration without jailbreaks; the go-to Frida front-end for mobile engagements.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



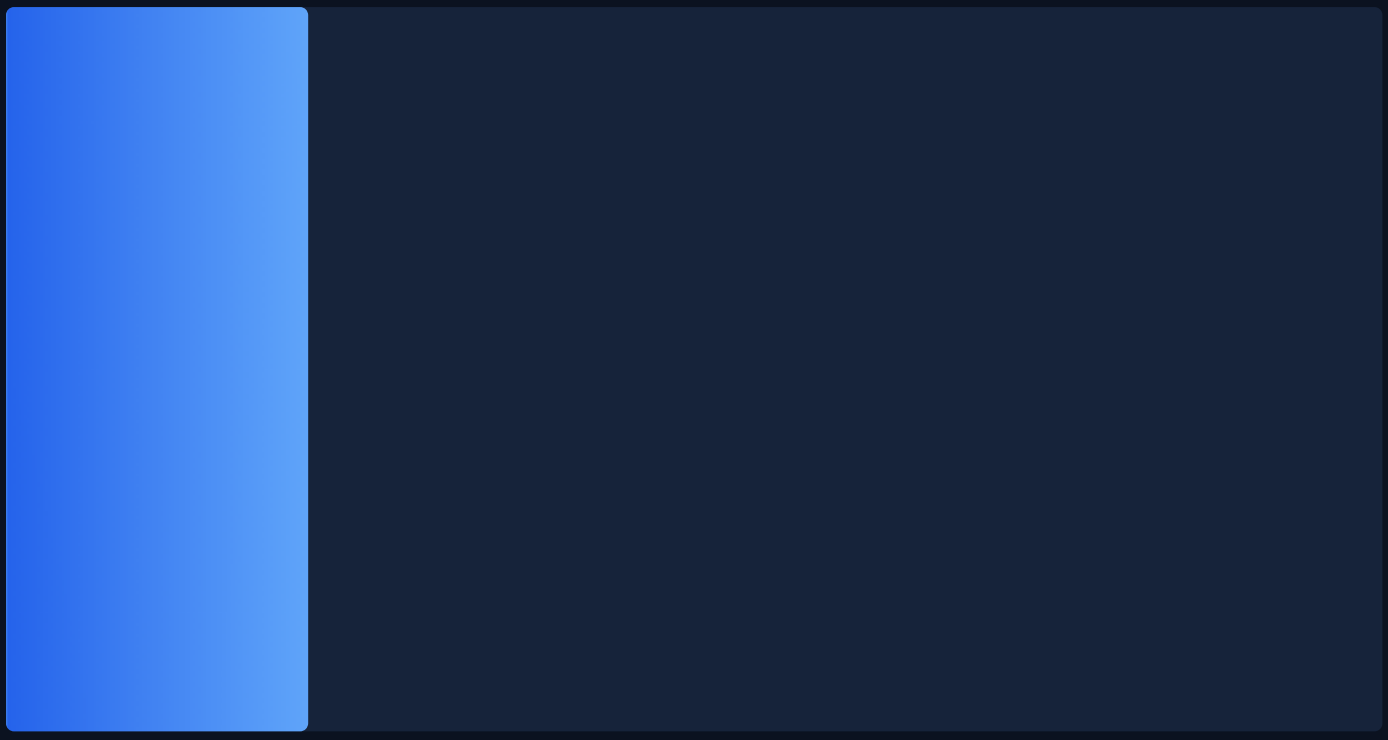
9	1,003	58	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 Tsunami

github.com/google/tsunami-security-scanner

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 8.6k	GITHUB STARS
927	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Tsunami is a general purpose network security scanner with an extensible plugin system for detecting high severity vulnerabilities with high confidence."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Google's security scanner for large fleets, focused on reliably exploitable high-severity flaws with few false positives.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams scanning large fleets of internet-facing services; Google's open-source answer to commercial enterprise web scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



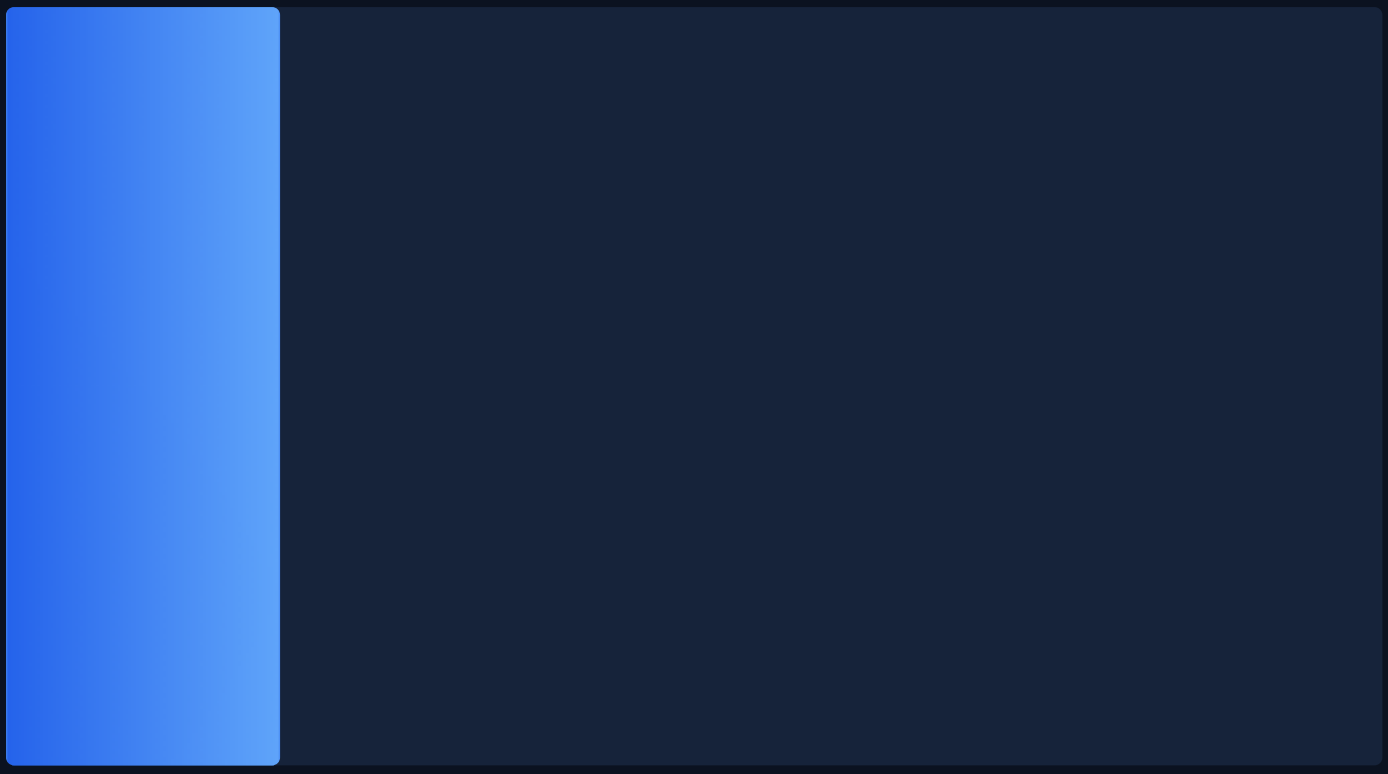
6	927	15	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 aircrack-ng

github.com/aircrack-ng/aircrack-ng

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,383	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WiFi security auditing tools suite"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the complete WiFi security audit suite: capture, inject and audit — the wireless standard for two decades.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by WiFi security auditors worldwide; the complete free suite replacing any commercial WiFi assessment tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



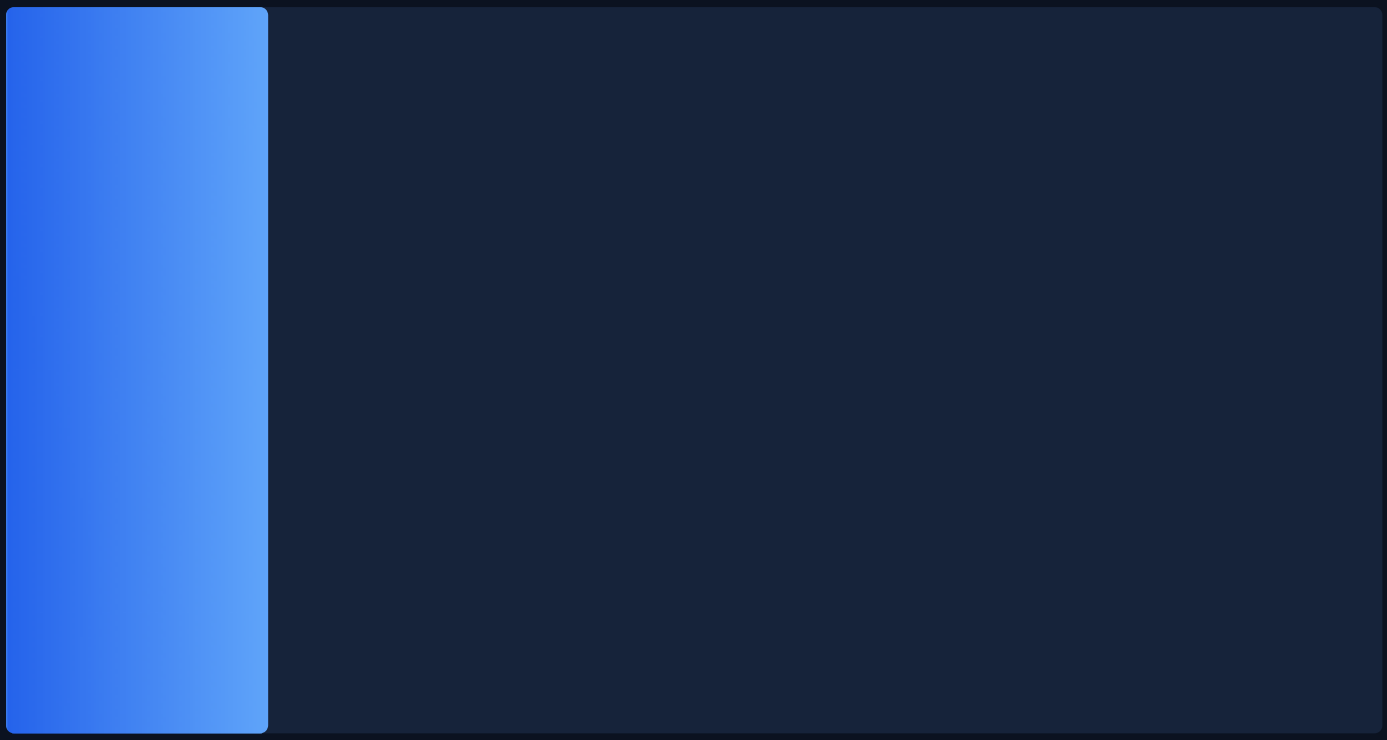
8	1,383	450	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 MITRE Caldera

github.com/apache/caldera

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.4k	GITHUB STARS
1,404	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Automated Adversary Emulation Platform"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

scalable adversary-emulation platform built on ATT&CK; run purple-team exercises that prove your detections actually fire.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by red teams and purple teams for automated adversary emulation; the open-source alternative to commercial breach-attack-simulation platforms like AttackIQ and SafeBreach.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



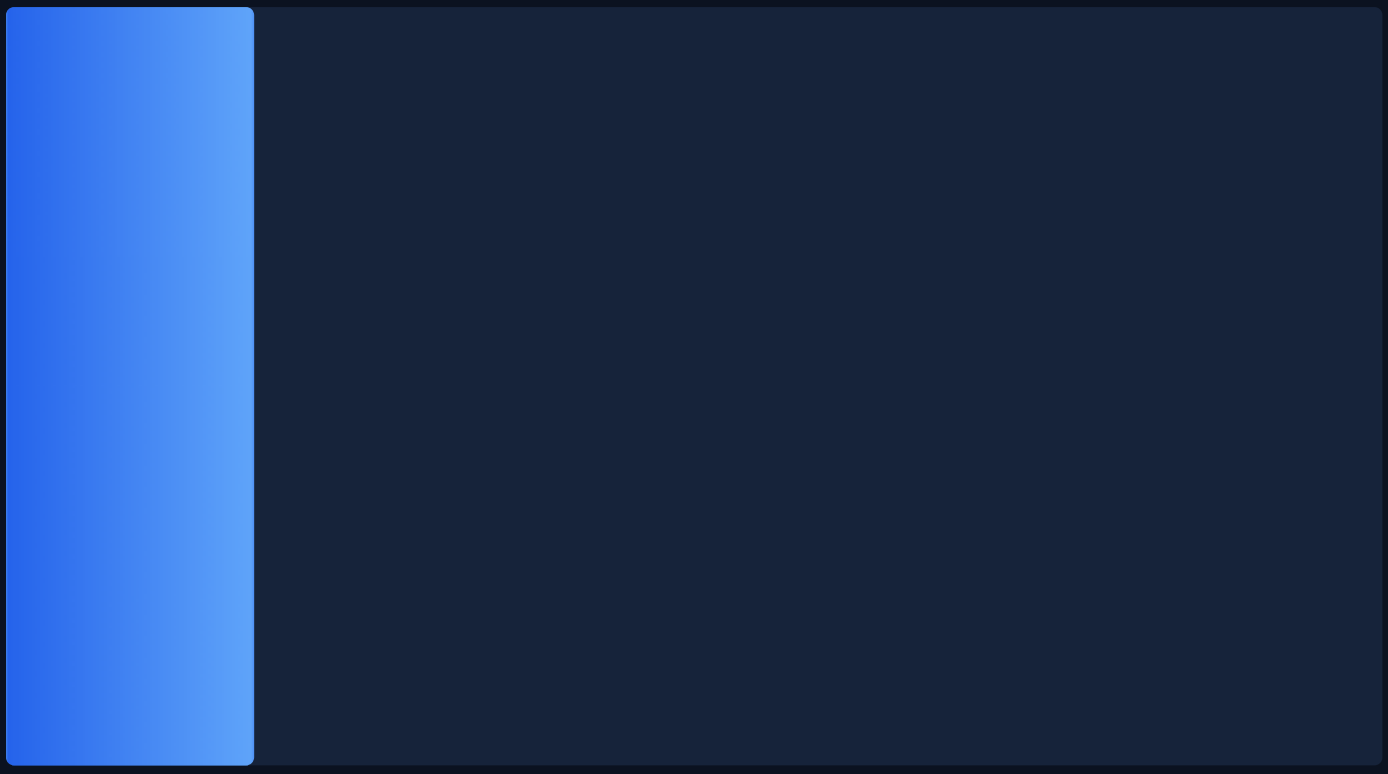
9	1,404	77	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 RsaCtfTool

github.com/Ganapati/RsaCtfTool

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.2k	GITHUB STARS
1,011	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"RSA attack tool (mainly for ctf) - retrieve private key from weak public key and/or uncipher data"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

RSA security-testing tool: attacks weak keys and unprotected disclosures purely offline, for auditors and CTF practice.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF players and crypto researchers attacking weak RSA keys; a niche free tool with no commercial counterpart.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



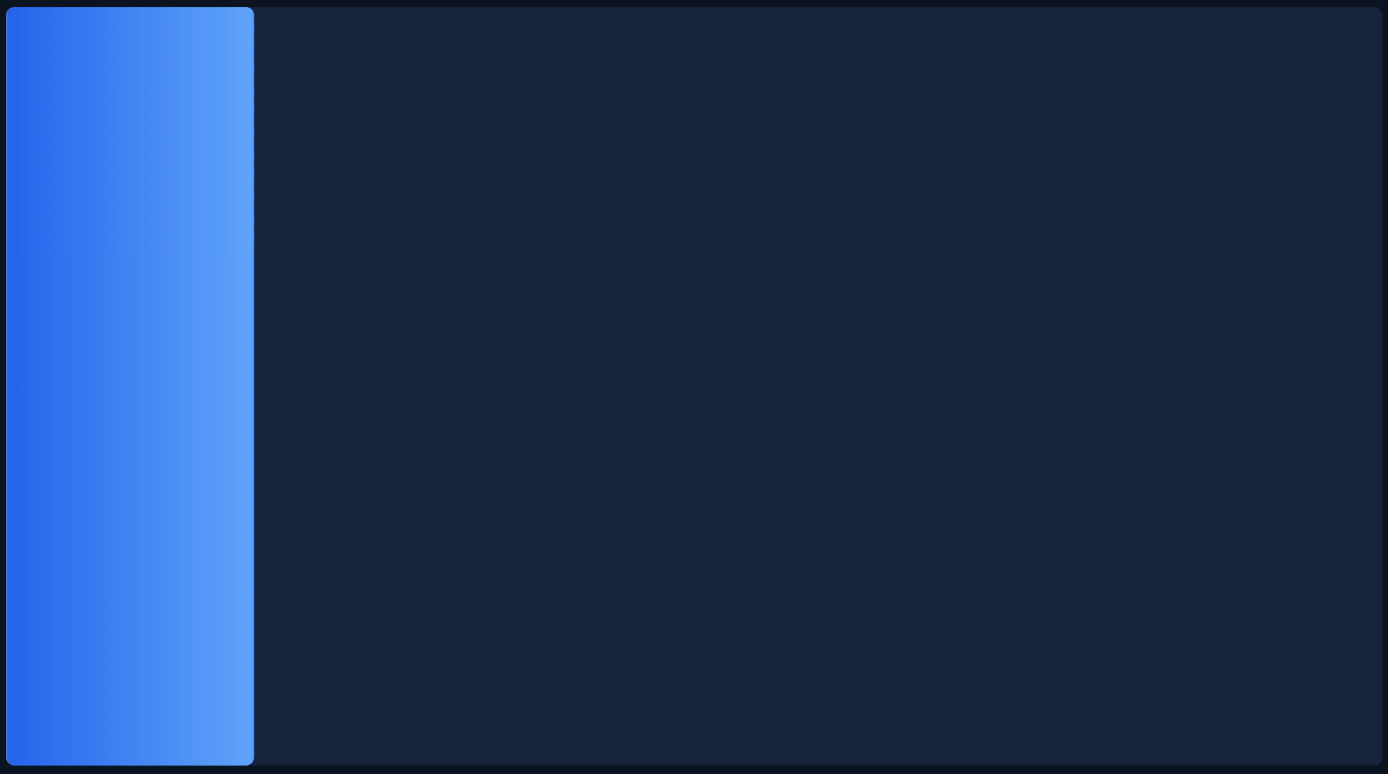
11	1,011	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 WhatWeb

github.com/urbanadventurer/WhatWeb

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.9k	GITHUB STARS
1,016	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2010	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Ruby	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Next generation web scanner"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

identifies what a website is built with — frameworks, CMSs, servers and versions — in one command.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams to fingerprint what a site runs on; the standard free tech-identifier behind many commercial recon feeds.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



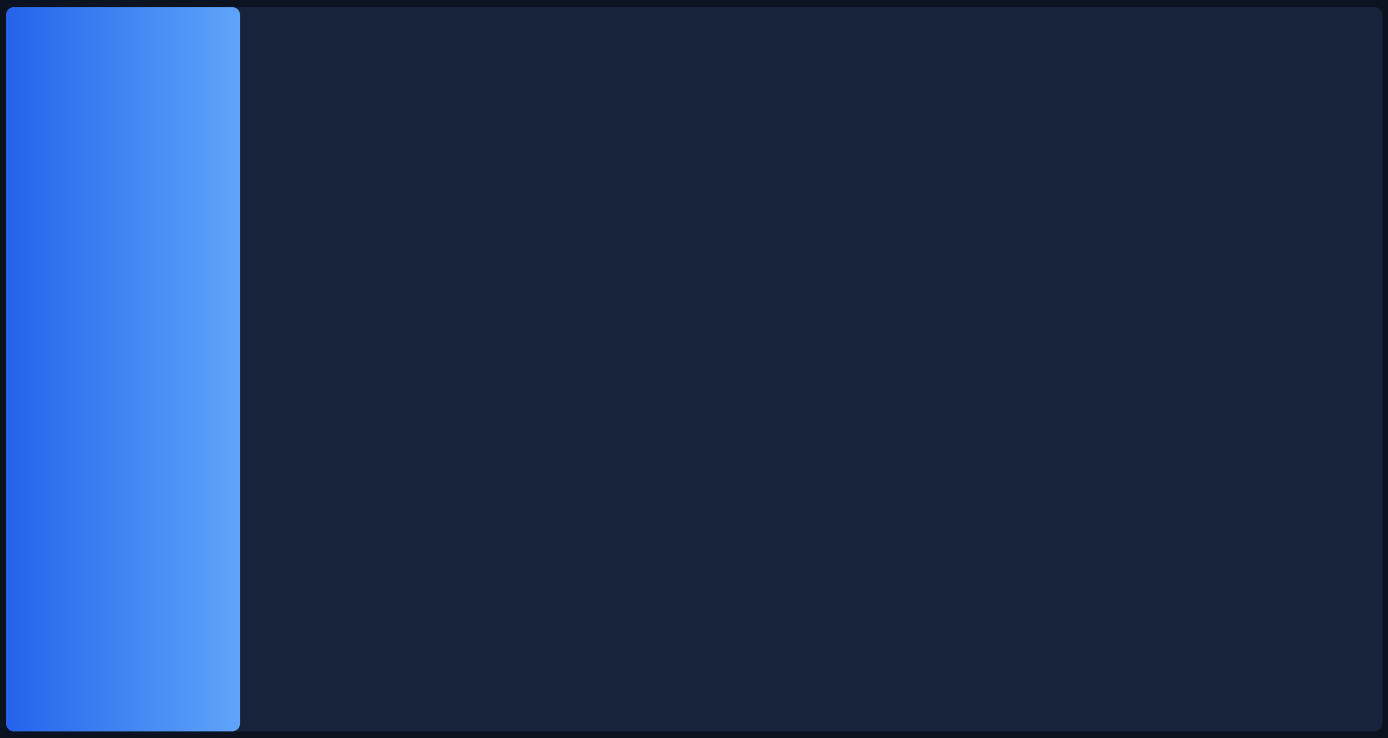
16	1,016	51	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 Responder

github.com/lgandx/Responder

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.6k	GITHUB STARS
871	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Responder is a LLMNR, NBT-NS and MDNS poisoner, with built-in HTTP/SMB/MSSQL/FTP/LDAP rogue authentication server supporting NTLMv1/NTLMv2/LMv2, Extended Security NTLMSSP and Basic HTTP authentication."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

LLMNR/NBT-NS/MDNS poisoner; the fastest way to demonstrate credential-leak exposure on an authorized internal network.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by internal penetration testers to demonstrate credential exposure on enterprise networks; the canonical LLMNR/NBT-NS poisoner.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



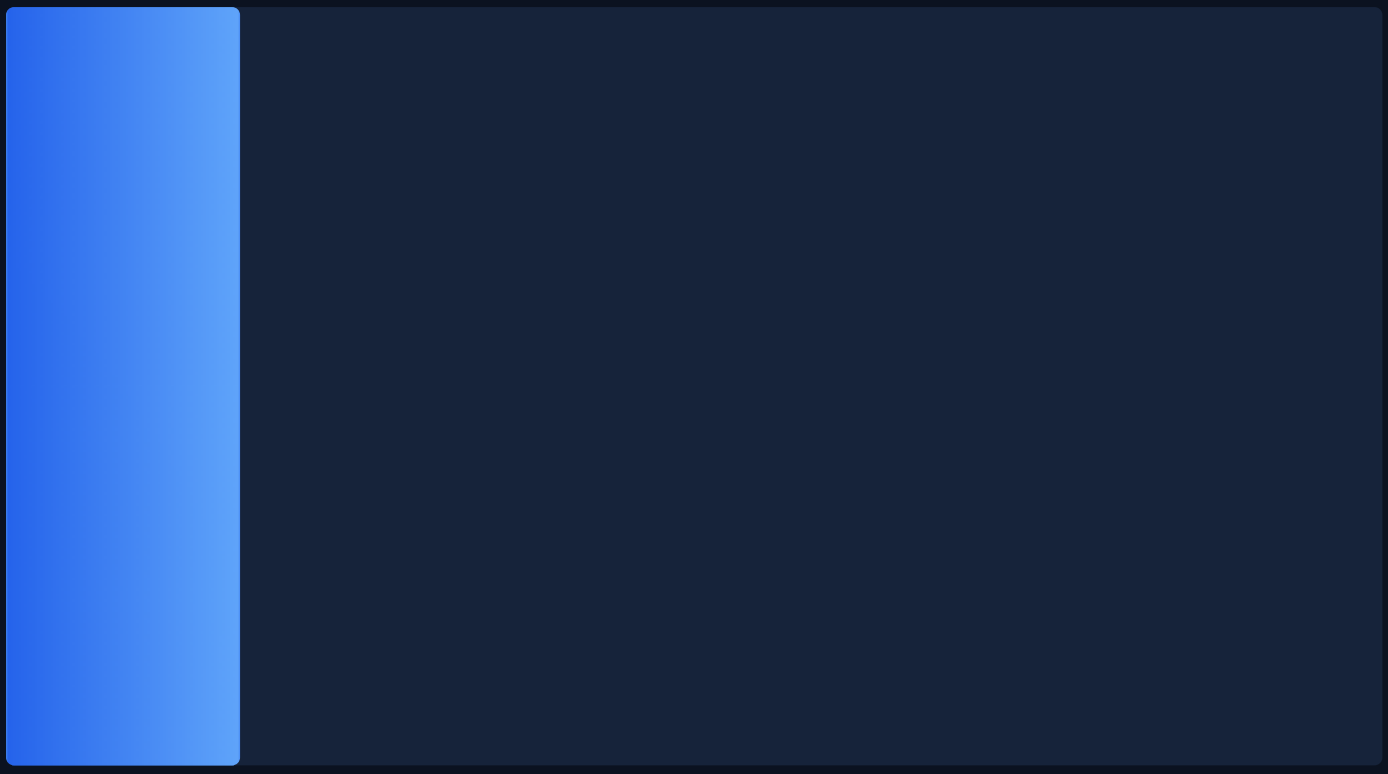
10	871	31	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

21 osmedeus

github.com/j3ssie/osmedeus

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,035	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A Modern Orchestration Engine for Security"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

workflow engine that chains recon and scanning into scheduled, repeatable attack-surface pipelines.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by recon teams automating full attack-surface workflows; the free alternative to commercial ASM platforms for scheduled recon.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



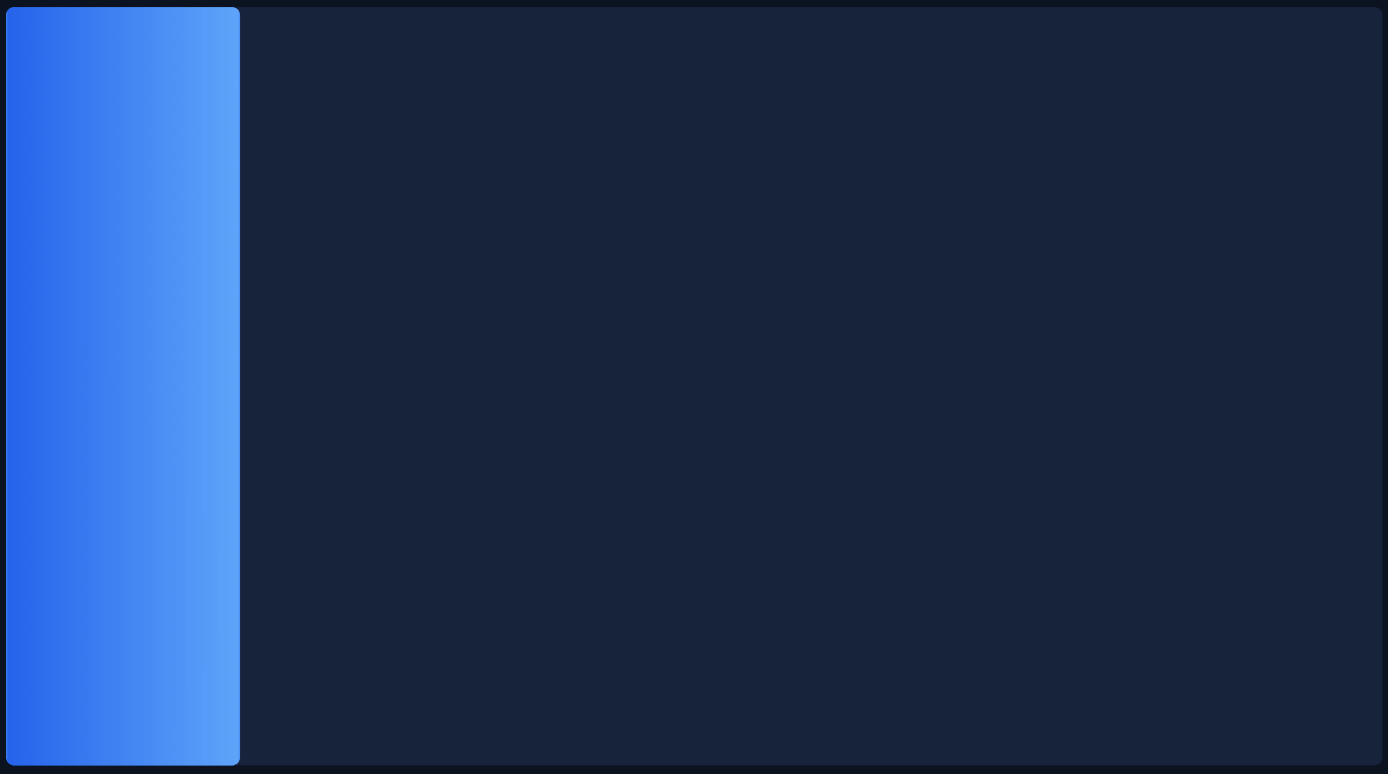
8	1,035	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 wafw00f

github.com/EnableSecurity/wafw00f

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,059	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WAFW00F allows one to identify and fingerprint Web Application Firewall (WAF) products protecting a website."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fingerprints the web application firewall sitting in front of a site so you know exactly what you're testing against.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters planning engagements to fingerprint WAFs first; the standard free WAF detector.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



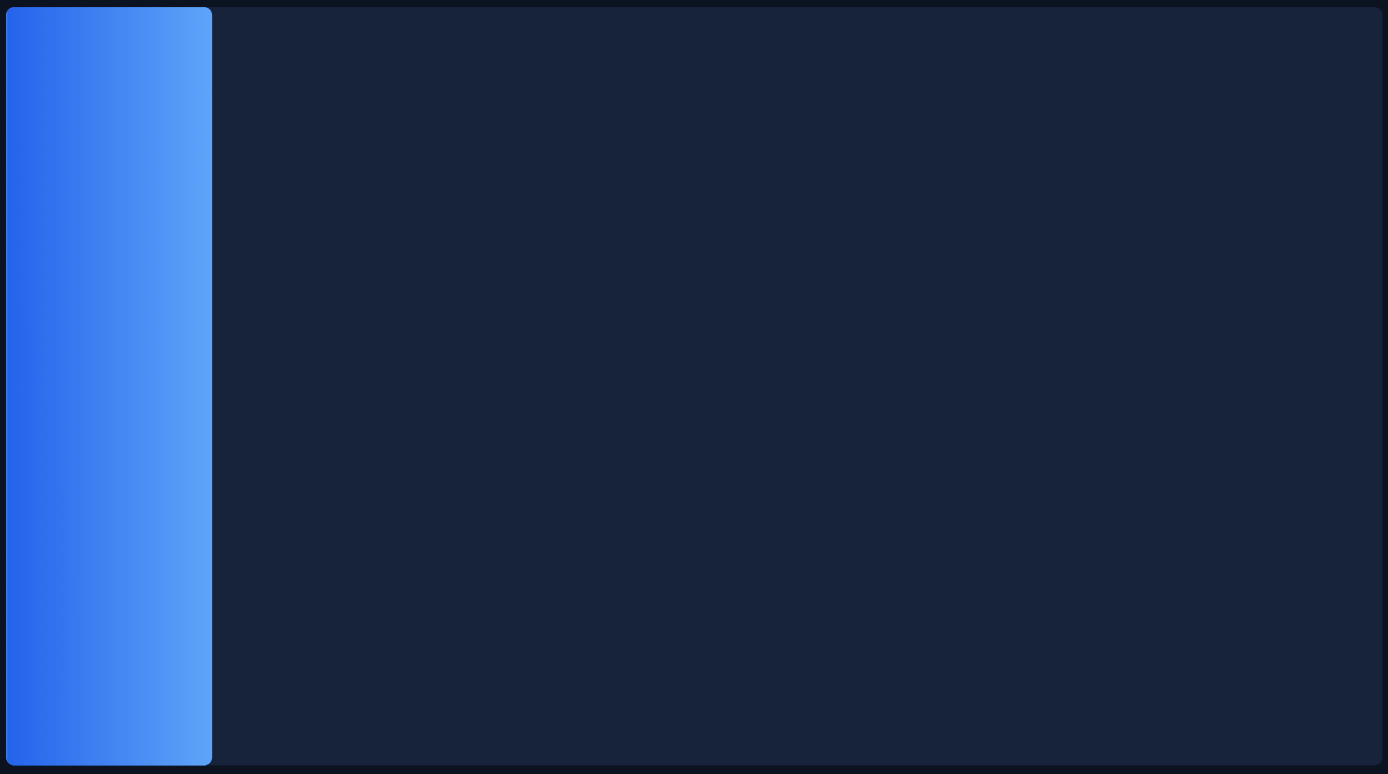
12	1,059	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 NetExec

github.com/Pennyw0rth/NetExec

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.9k	GITHUB STARS
784	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2023	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-2-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The Network Execution Tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

CrackMapExec's actively maintained successor; audit credential hygiene and service misconfigurations across whole subnets.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by internal network auditors and AD pentesters for credential-hygiene sweeps.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



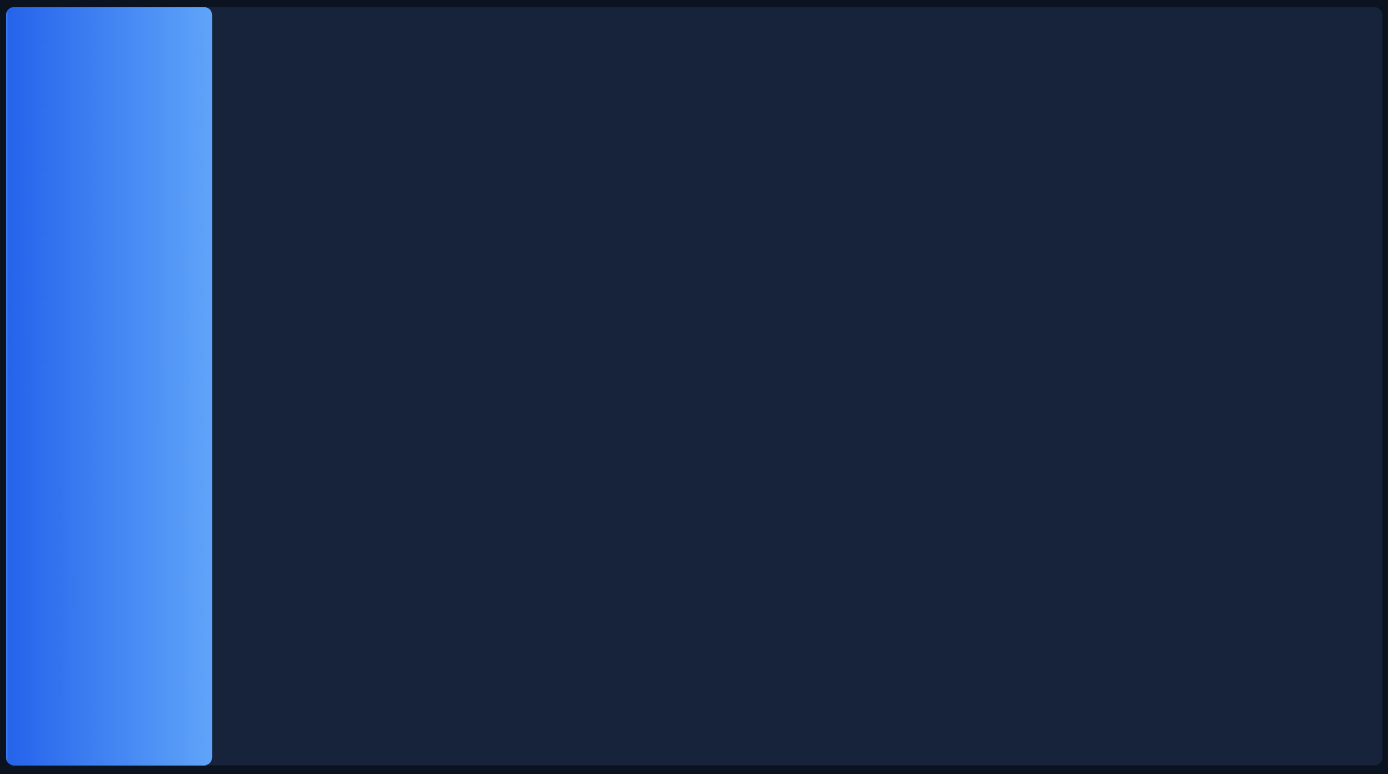
3	784	164	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 commix

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/commixproject/commix

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.9k	GITHUB STARS
940	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Automated All-in-One OS command injection exploitation tool."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

automated OS command injection detection and exploitation for web tests.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters for command-injection proof; a focused free tool that complements general-purpose commercial scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



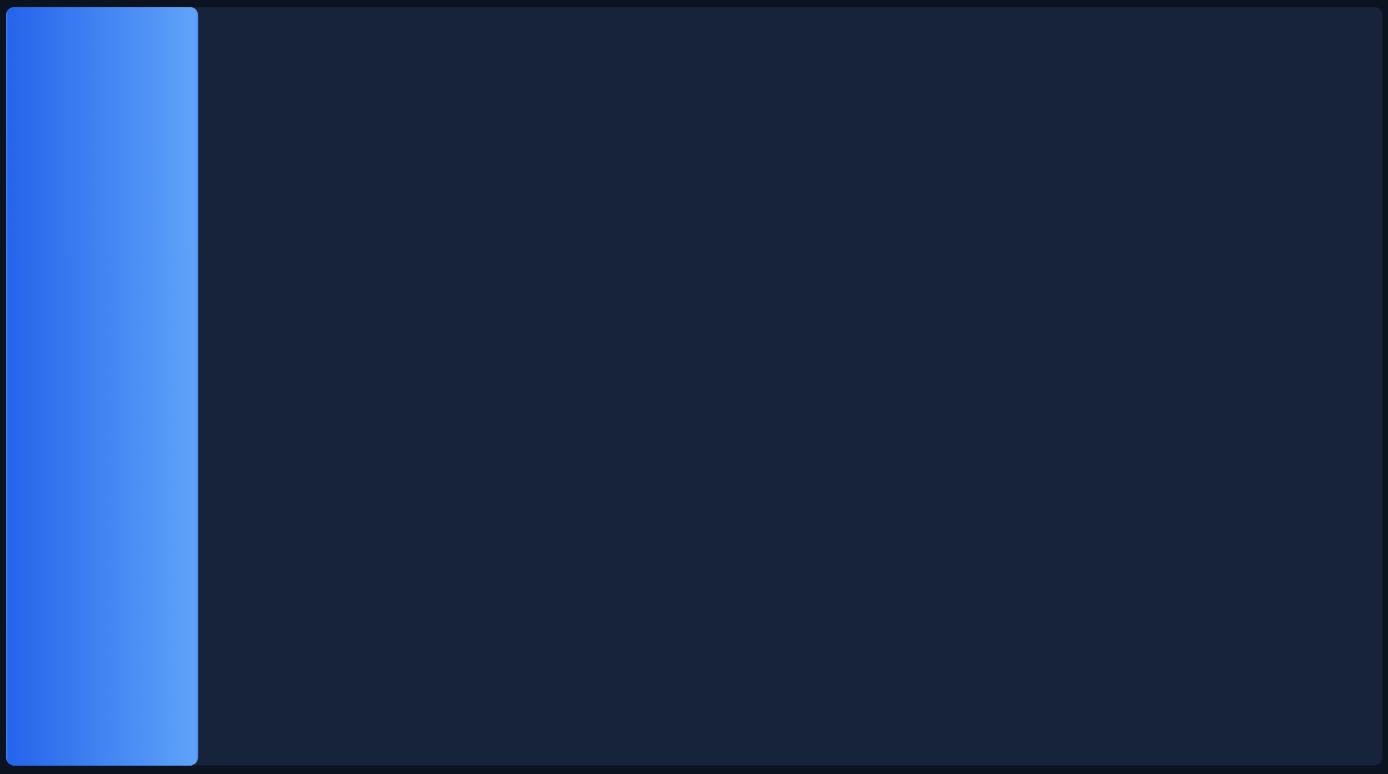
11	940	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 Dalfox

github.com/hahwul/dalfox

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.3k	GITHUB STARS
568	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🌙🦊 Dalfox is a powerful open-source XSS scanner and utility focused on automation."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fast XSS scanner with DOM-aware analysis and a strong payload set; the modern XSS go-to.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters for fast, DOM-aware XSS scanning; a favorite free alternative to Burp's scanner for XSS-only sweeps.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



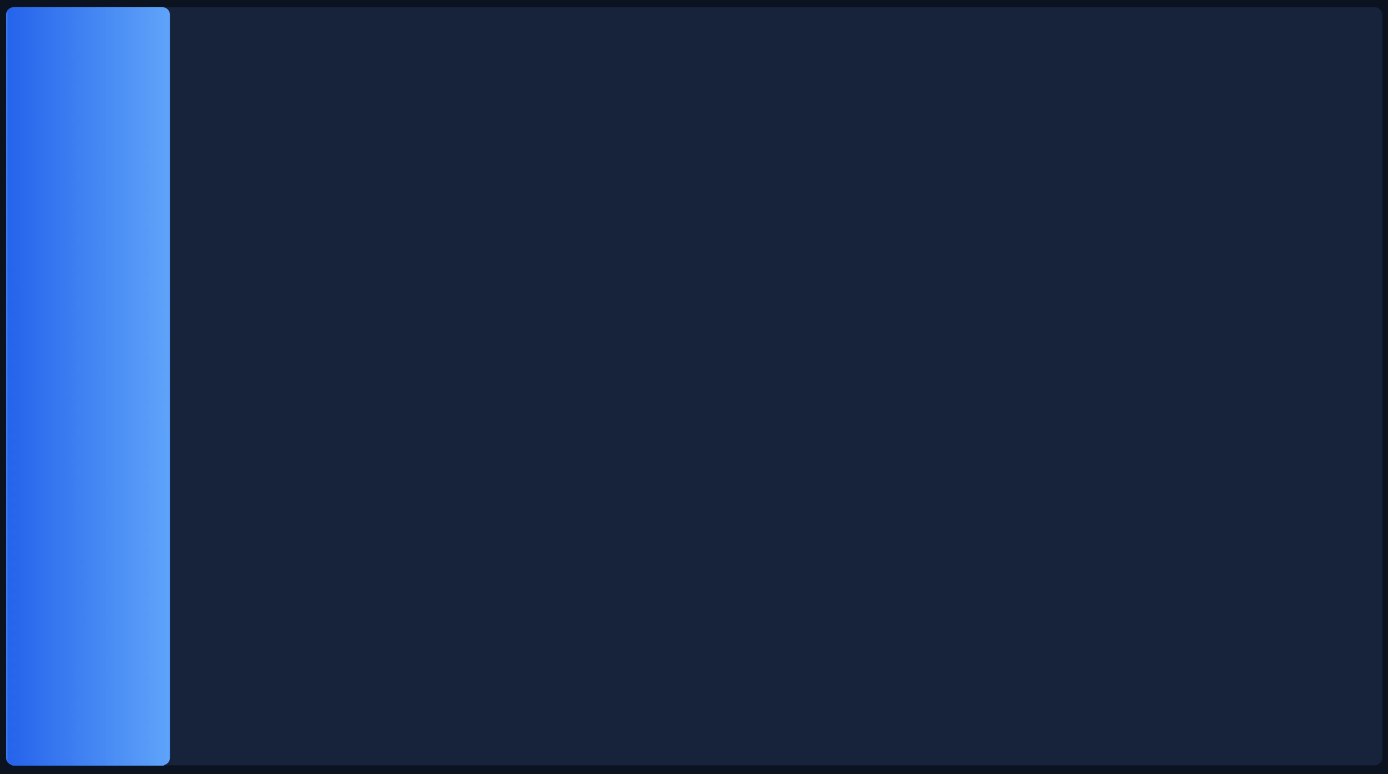
6	568	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 OpenVAS Scanner

github.com/greenbone/openvas-scanner

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.9k	GITHUB STARS
805	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"This repository contains the scanner component for Greenbone Community Edition."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Greenbone's open-source vulnerability scanning engine for network and service flaws.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams running unauthenticated network vulnerability scans; the classic open-source alternative to Nessus, Qualys and Rapid7 InsightVM.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

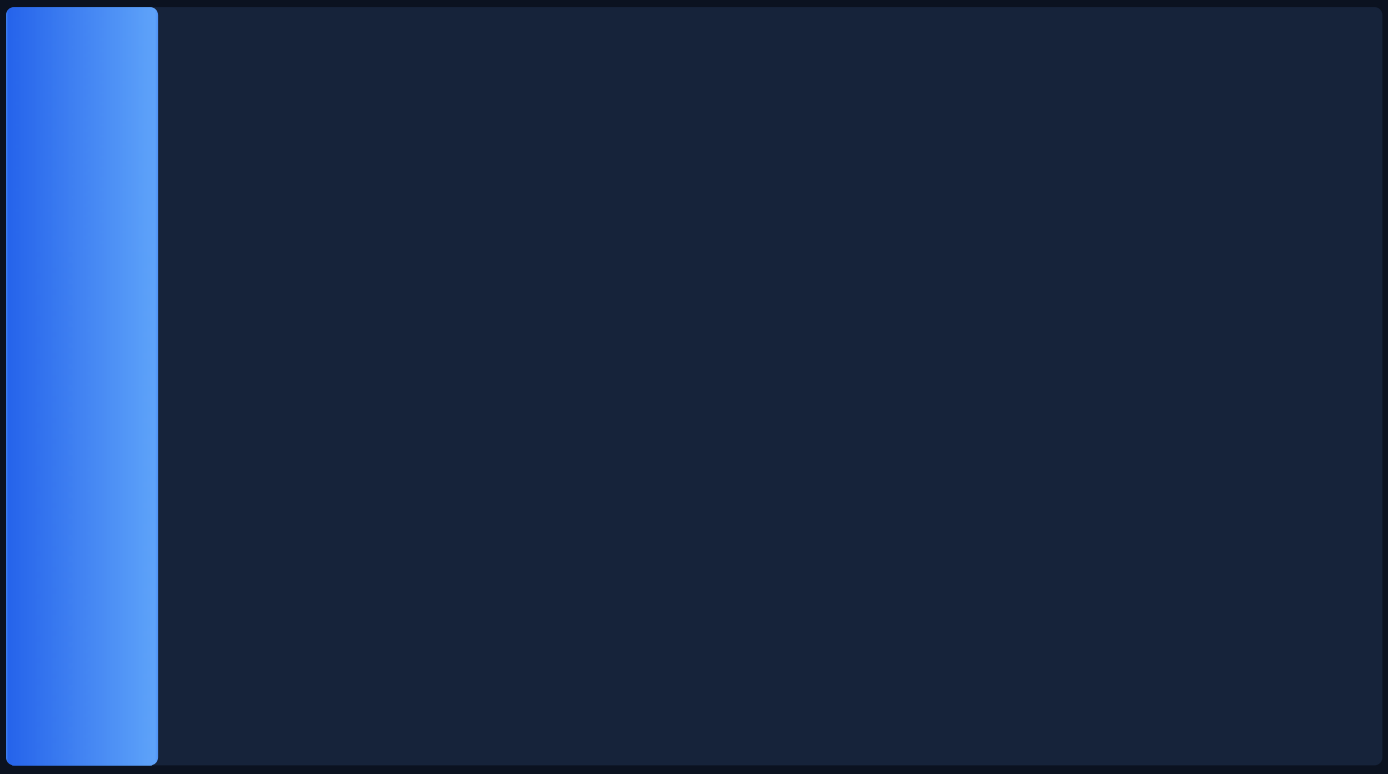


8	805	25	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

27 tplmap

github.com/epinna/tplmap

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.2k	GITHUB STARS
684	FORKS
2024-04	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Server-Side Template Injection and Code Injection Detection and Exploitation Tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

server-side template injection detection and exploitation across a dozen template engines; quiet upstream but still the SSTI reference.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters for server-side template injection proof across a dozen engines; no commercial equivalent needed.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



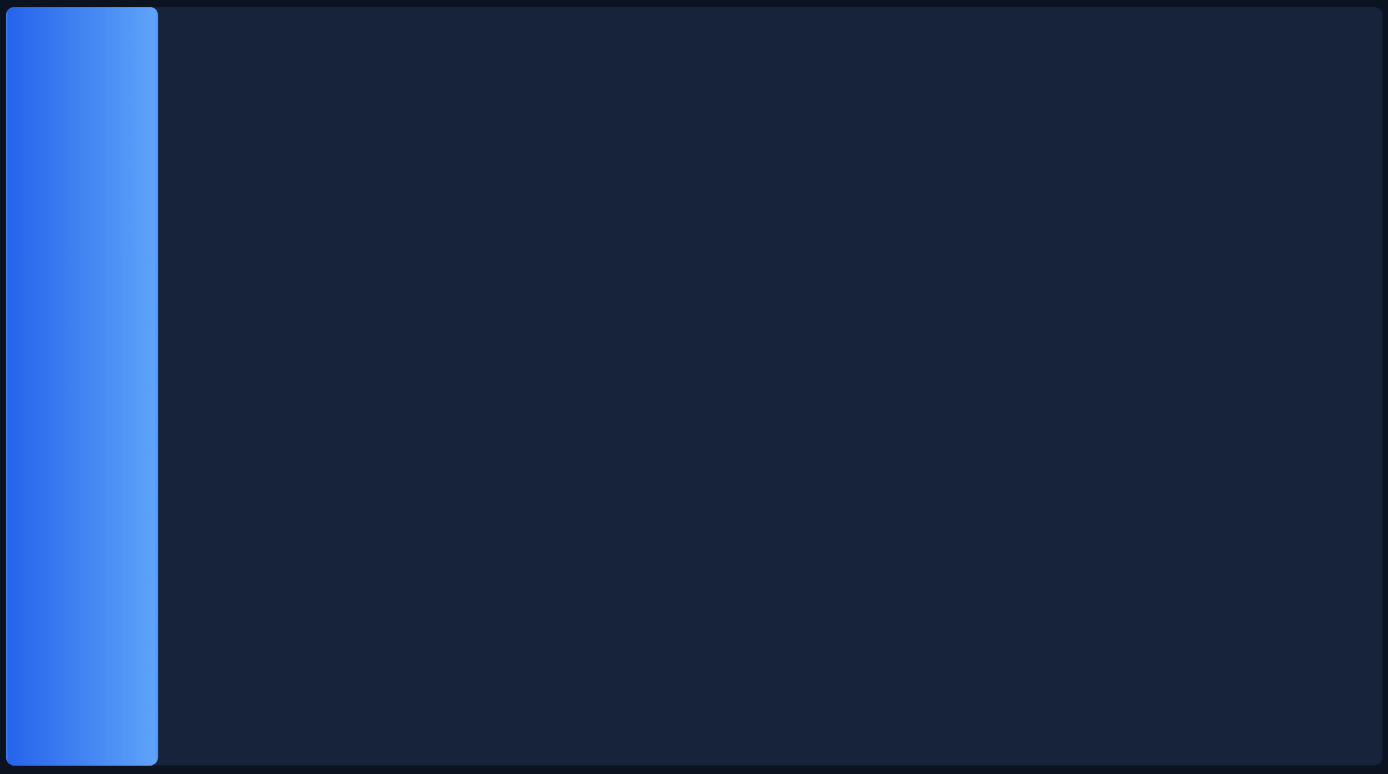
10	684	46	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 GitTools

github.com/internetwache/GitTools

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.2k	GITHUB STARS
632	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A repository with 3 tools for pwn'ing websites with .git repositories available"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

recovers an exposed `.git` directory into full source and commit history — audit your servers before attackers do.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters to recover exposed .git directories into full source; the go-to free tool for this bug class.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

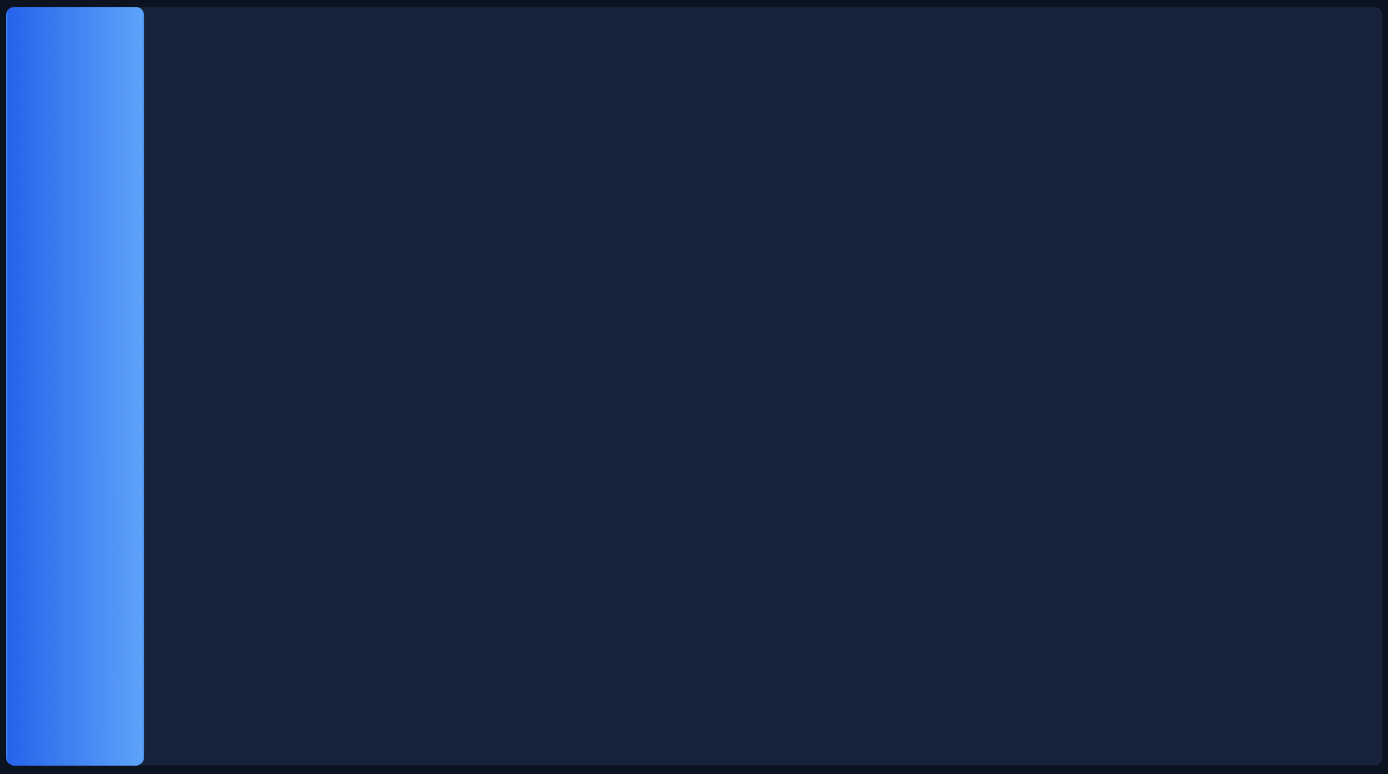


11	632	2	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 Ghauri

github.com/r0oth3x49/ghauri

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.1k	GITHUB STARS
423	FORKS
2025-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An advanced cross-platform tool that automates the process of detecting and exploiting SQL injection security flaws"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a strong sqlmap alternative for error/union/blind SQLi with clever parameter tampering; slower release cadence but unique value.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters for tricky blind, error-based and time-based SQLi.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



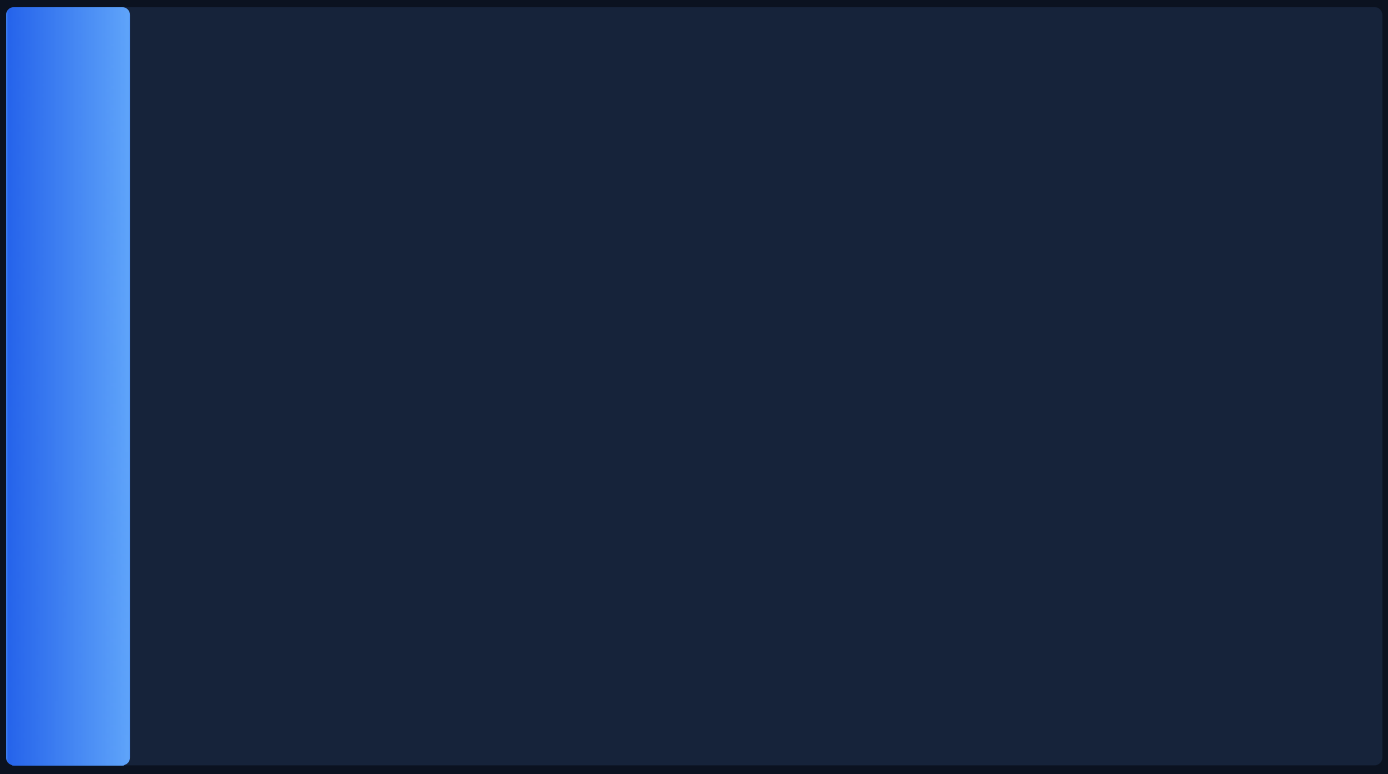
4	423	25	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

30 BloodHound

github.com/SpecterOps/BloodHound

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.5k	GITHUB STARS
387	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2023	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Six Degrees of Domain Admin"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

maps the shortest attack paths through Active Directory; defenders run it to find and fix their way to Domain Admin.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Active Directory pentesters to map hidden attack paths; the standard tool defenders also run to harden AD.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



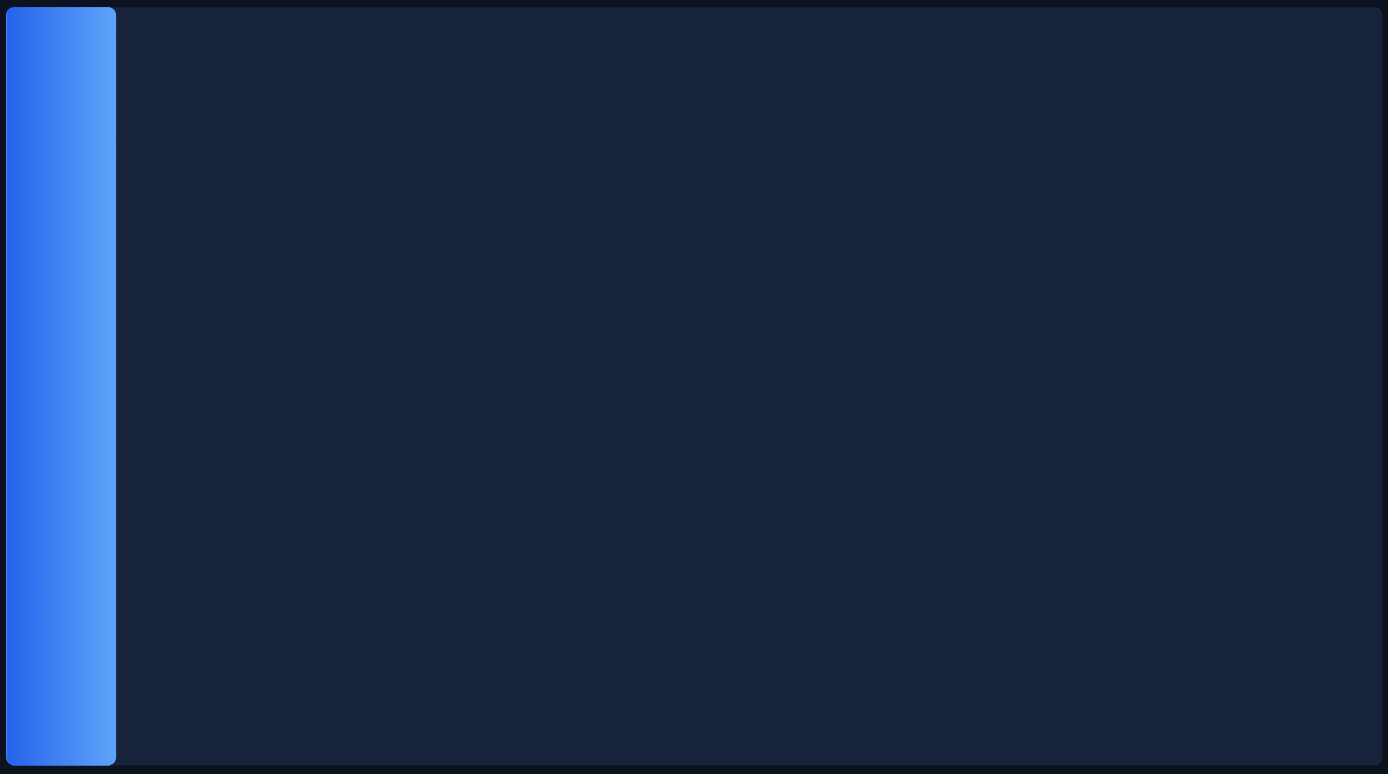
3	387	118	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

31 kiterunner

github.com/assetnote/kiterunner

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.3k	GITHUB STARS
340	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Contextual Content Discovery Tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

API route brute-forcer with method-aware wordlists derived from Swagger specs; dormant upstream, still the reference.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by API security testers brute-forcing routes with method-aware wordlists; the open-source alternative to commercial API discovery scans.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



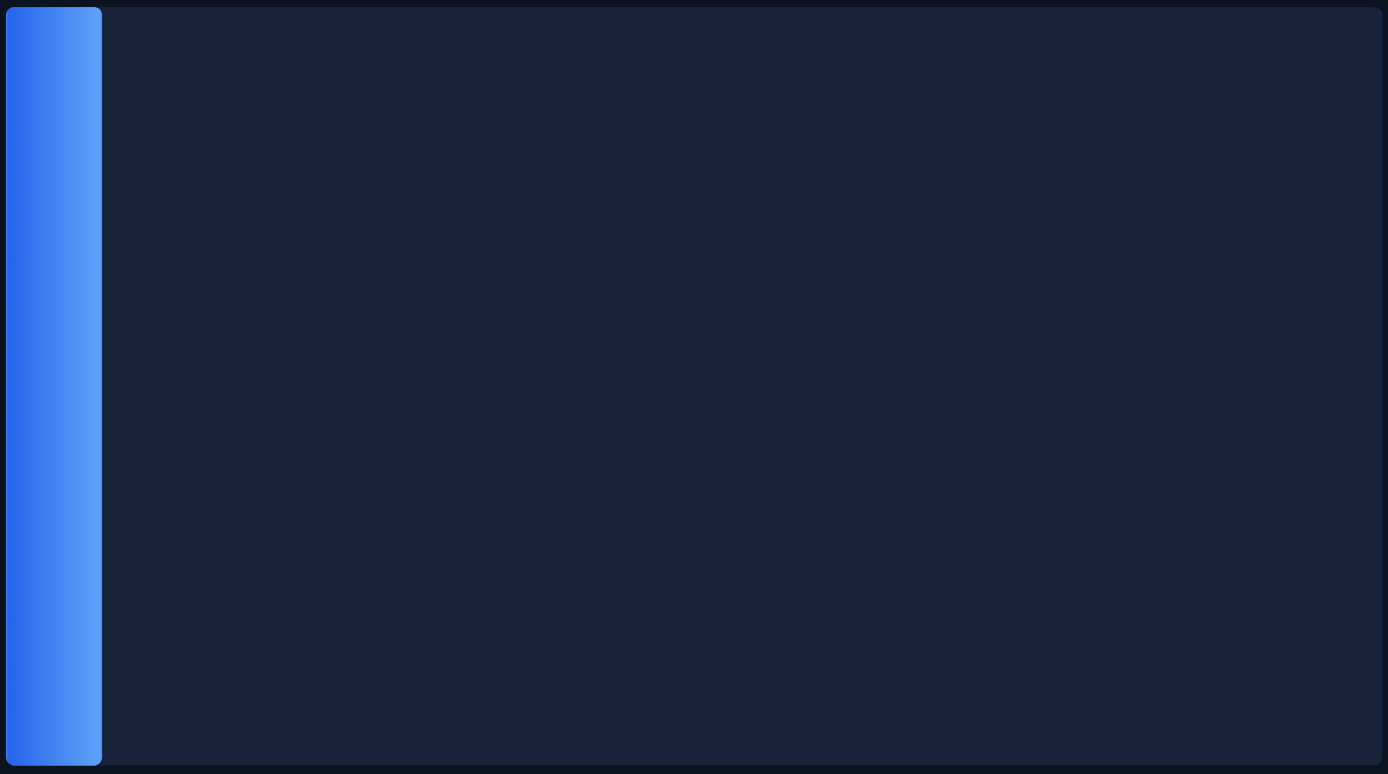
5	340	51	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

32 ettercap

github.com/Ettercap/ettercap

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.8k	GITHUB STARS
538	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Ettercap Project"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the veteran MITM analysis suite for ARP poisoning, sniffing and protocol dissection — bettercap's classic sibling.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network pentesters and students learning MITM analysis; the veteran suite that inspired later tools like Bettercap.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



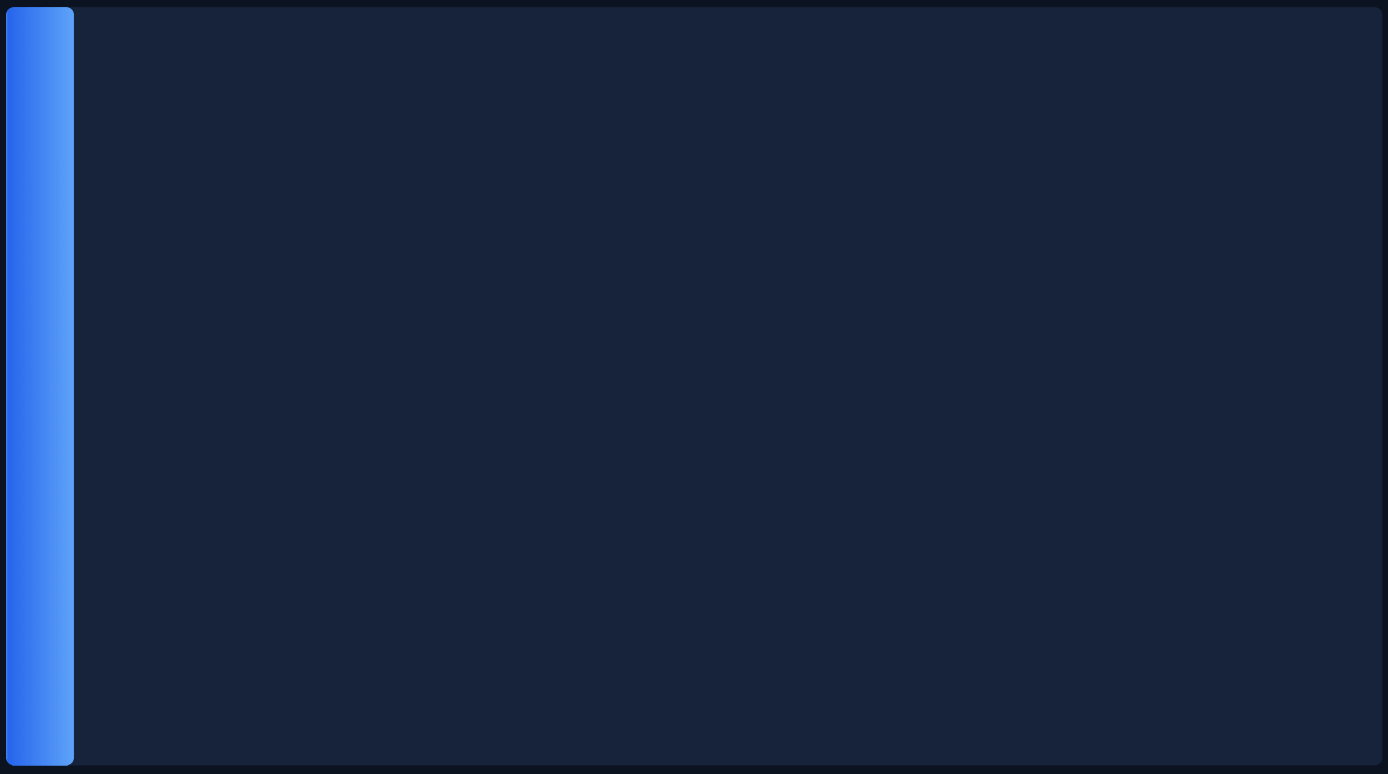
14	538	124	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

33 wapiti

github.com/wapiti-scanner/wapiti

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.9k	GITHUB STARS
276	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Web vulnerability scanner written in Python3"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source black-box web vulnerability scanner that crawls and audits without needing a browser.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters and CI pipelines for black-box web scanning; a solid free alternative to paid web vulnerability scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

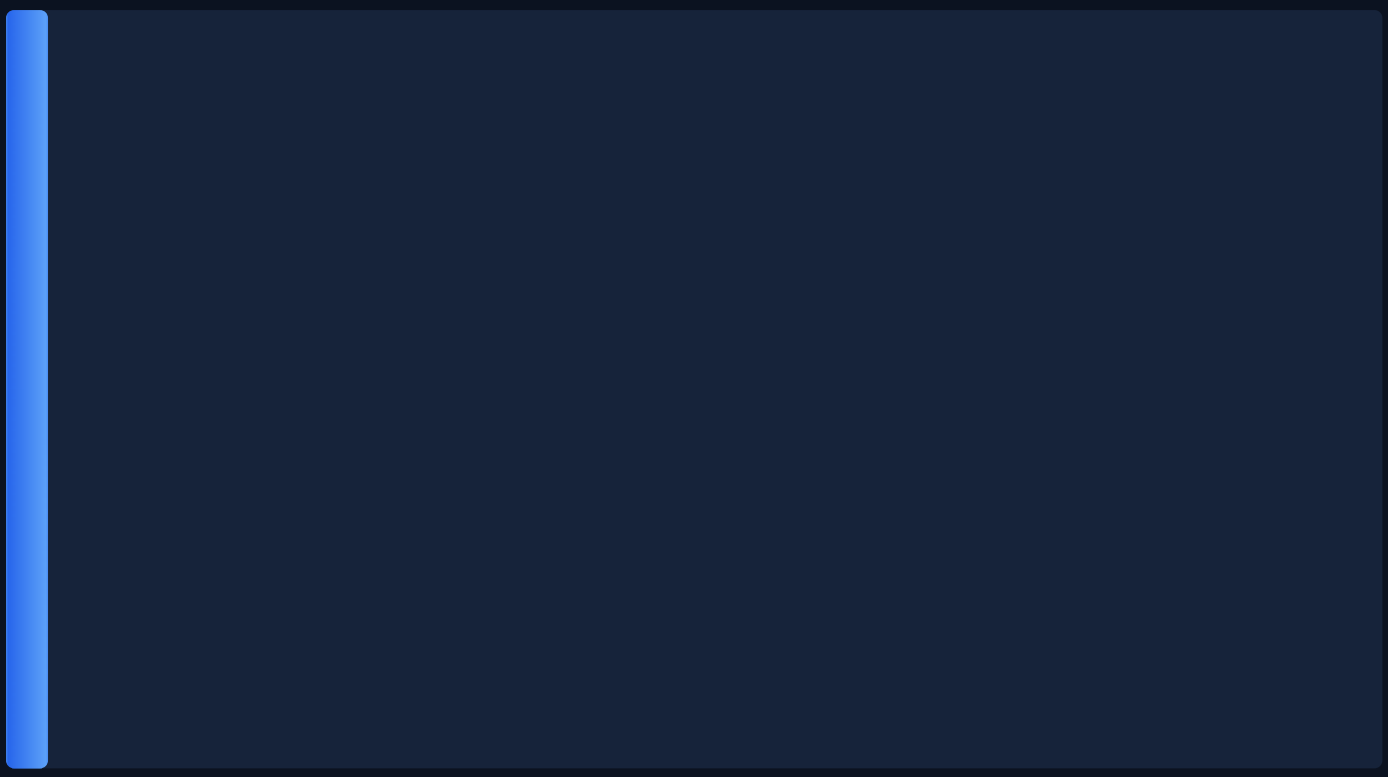


6	276	8	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

34 JoomScan

github.com/OWASP/joomscan

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.2k	GITHUB STARS
249	FORKS
2024-09	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Raku	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Joomla Vulnerability Scanner Project https://www.secologist.com/"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

OWASP's Joomla scanner: vulnerable components and misconfigurations on Joomla sites; quiet upstream, still OWASP's reference.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters auditing Joomla deployments; OWASP's free Joomla scanner.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



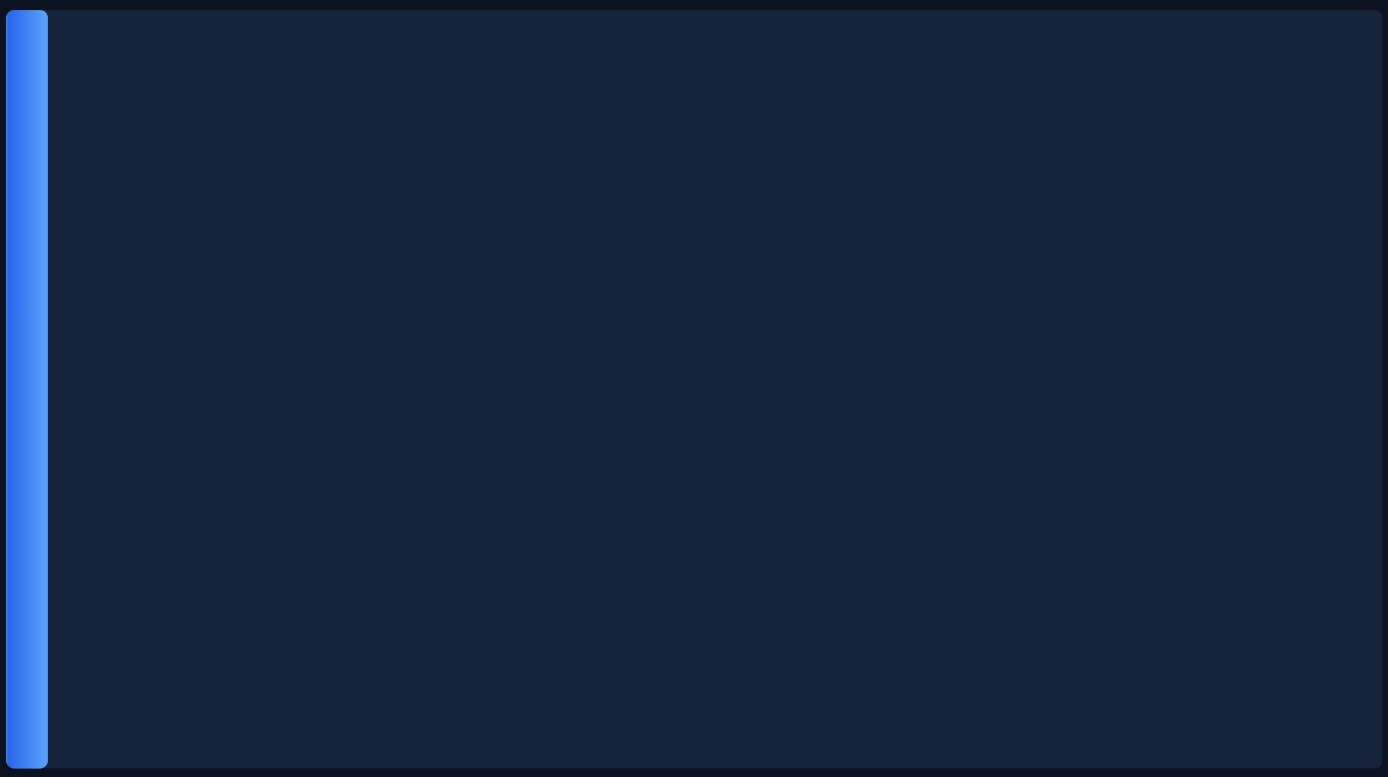
10	249	24	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

35 Pywerview

github.com/the-useless-one/pywerview

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.1k	GITHUB STARS
129	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A (partial) Python rewriting of PowerSploit's PowerView"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a Python port of PowerView's AD recon verbs; same questions, no Windows host required.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by AD pentesters who live on Linux but need PowerView-style Windows enumeration; the Python port of the classic PowerView.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



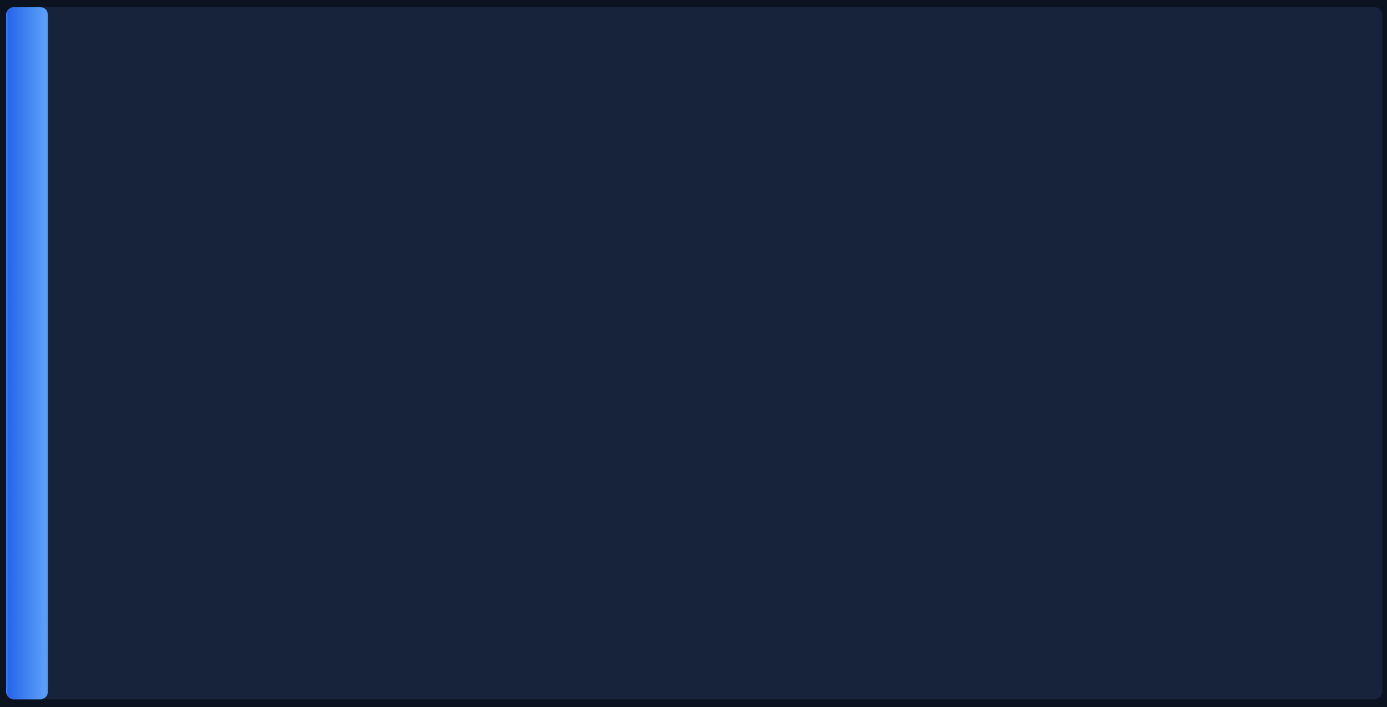
10	129	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

36 goshs

github.com/goshs-labs/goshs

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 989	GITHUB STARS
59	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Feature-rich single-binary file server for red teamers and developers. HTTP/S · WebDAV · FTP/SFTP · SMB · LDAP/S · NTLM hash capture · DNS/SMTP callbacks · TLS · Auth · Share links. A powerful python3 -m http.server re"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

hardened HTTP file-transfer server built for engagements: upload/download, authentication, access control and TLS — the modern replacement for `python -m http.server`.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters on engagements as a hardened file-transfer server; the security-hardened alternative to spinning up ad-hoc Python servers.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



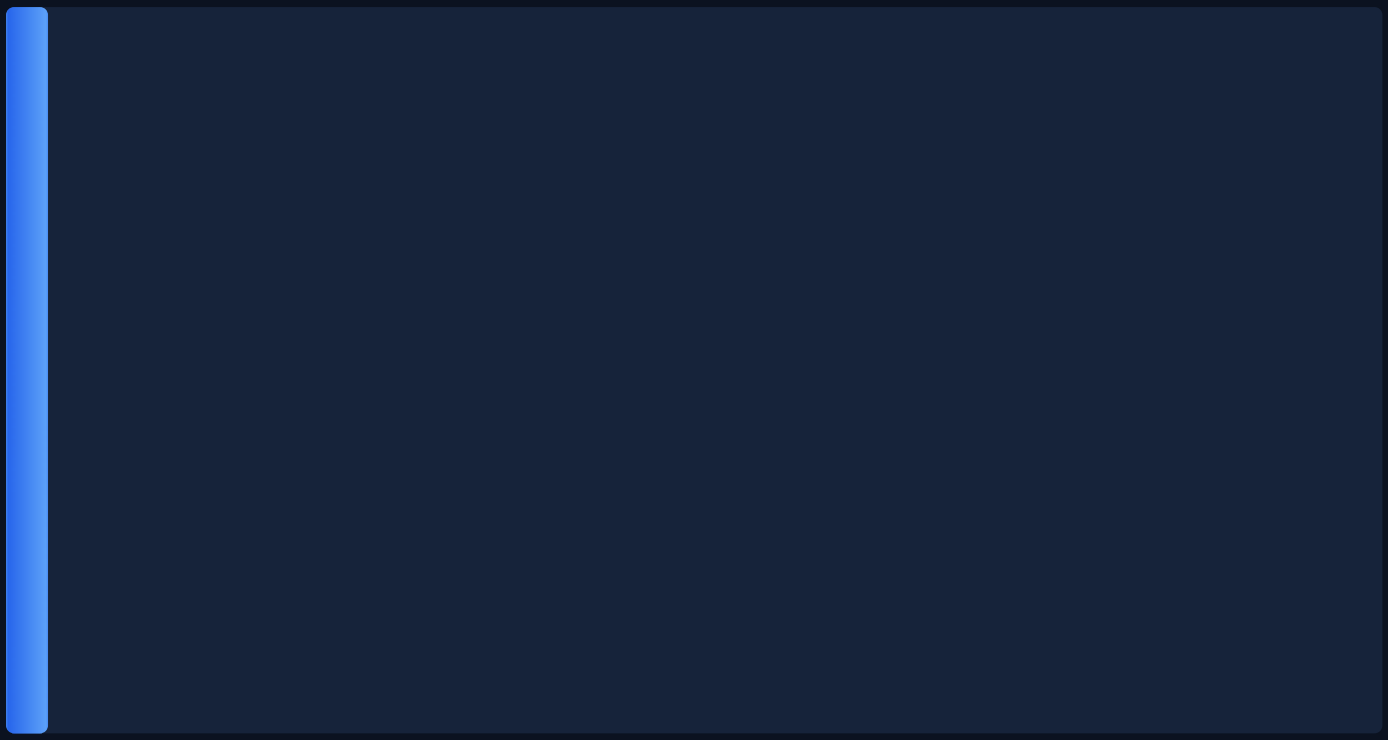
6	59	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

37 h5i

github.com/h5i-dev/h5i

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 784	GITHUB STARS
75	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2026	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Build, hack, and verify web apps. Find vulnerabilities through red-teaming. Formally verify properties of Rust codes in Lean 4."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

agent-native web-security workspace: deterministic recon, secrets scanning, DOM post-message auditing and CI regression checks — fully usable without any LLM key.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security engineers wanting agent-native, deterministic web checks; a newer open alternative to dashboard-driven commercial scanners.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

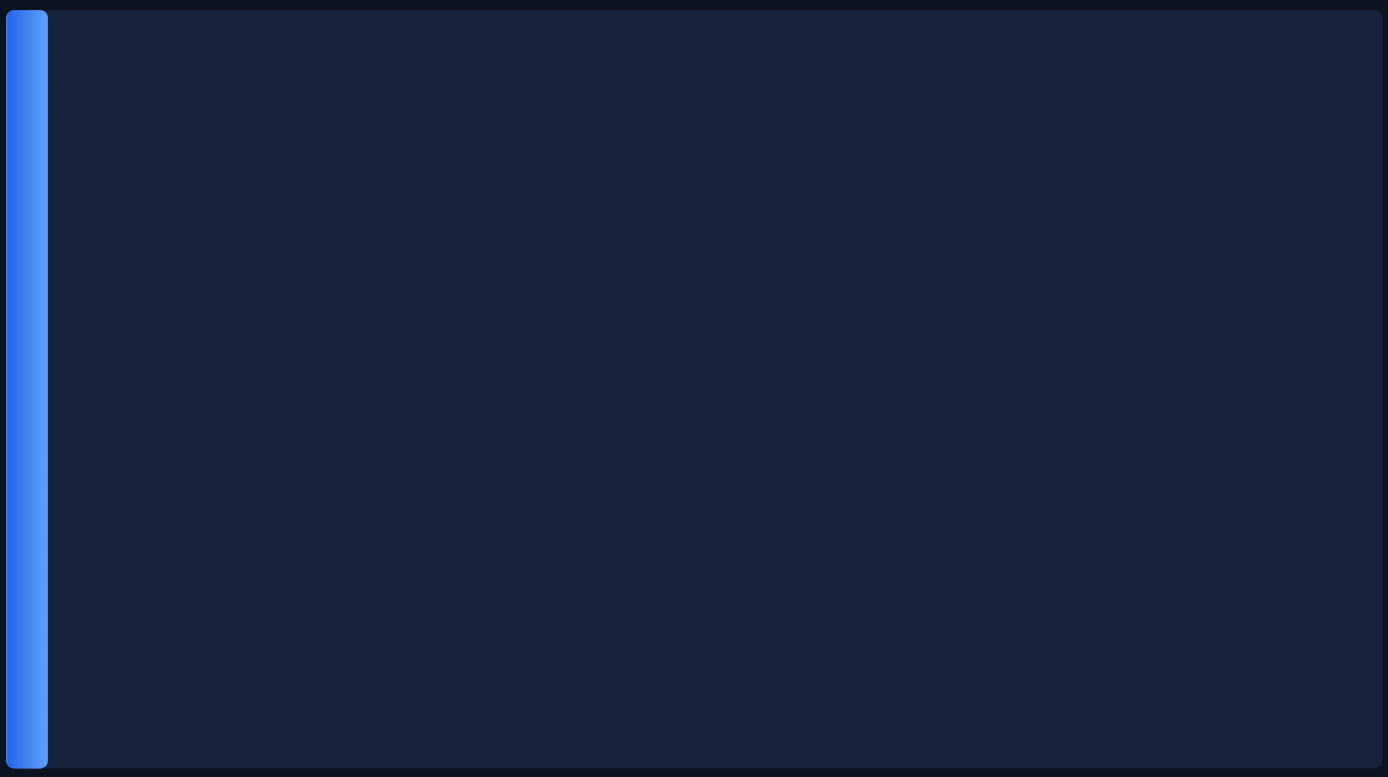


0	75	13	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

38 ACSTIS

github.com/tijme/angularjs-csti-scanner

star weight vs realm #1



★ 326	GITHUB STARS
94	FORKS
2021-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Automated client-side template injection (sandbox escape/bypass) detection for AngularJS v1.x."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic AngularJS client-side template injection scanner — legacy framework, still found everywhere.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters verifying this niche on legacy apps. (unmaintained classic)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



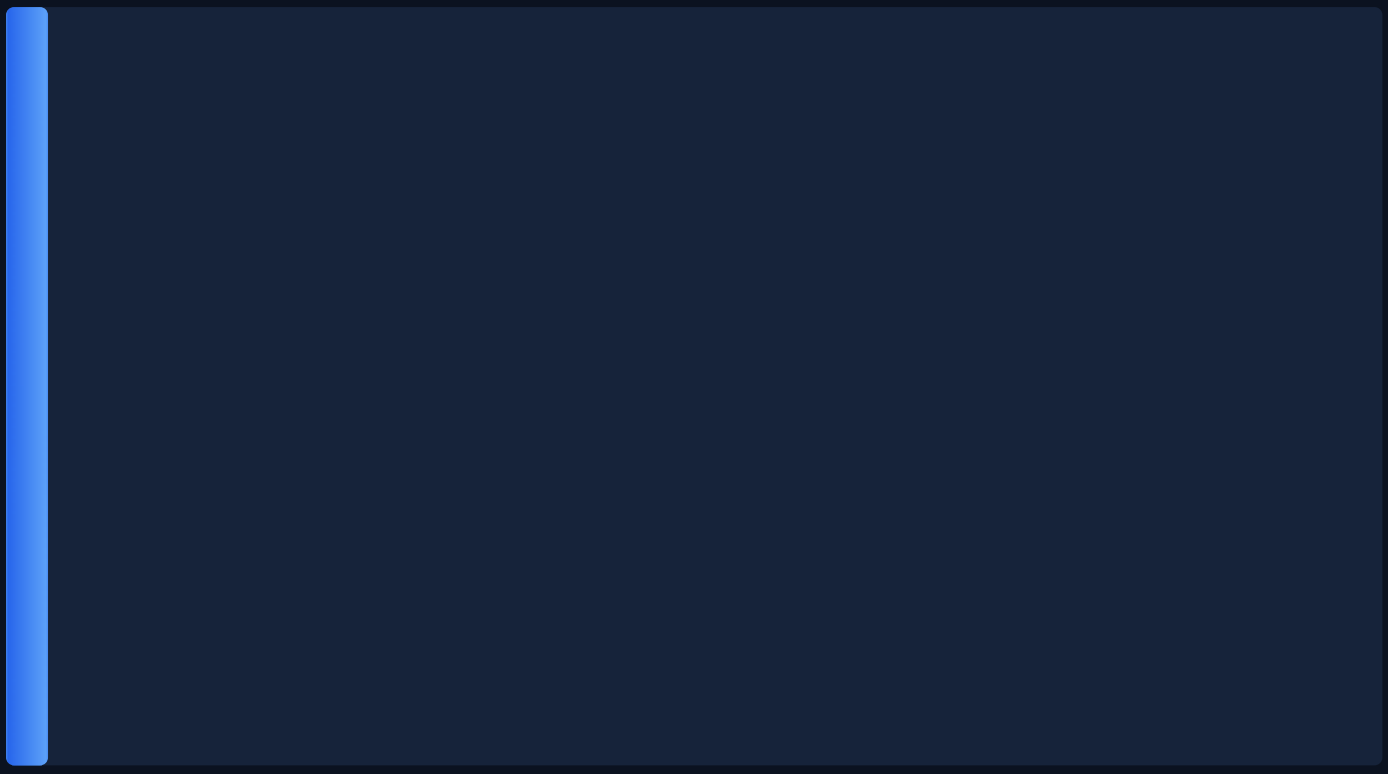
9	94	1	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

39 jiraffe

github.com/0x48piraj/jiraffe

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 206	GITHUB STARS
28	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"One stop place for Jira security reconnaissance and exploitation in your proximity"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Jira recon and security auditing: version fingerprinting, gadget/permission checks and CVE mapping for authorized instances.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug bounty hunters targeting Atlassian deployments; a focused free exploitation kit for the Jira bug class.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



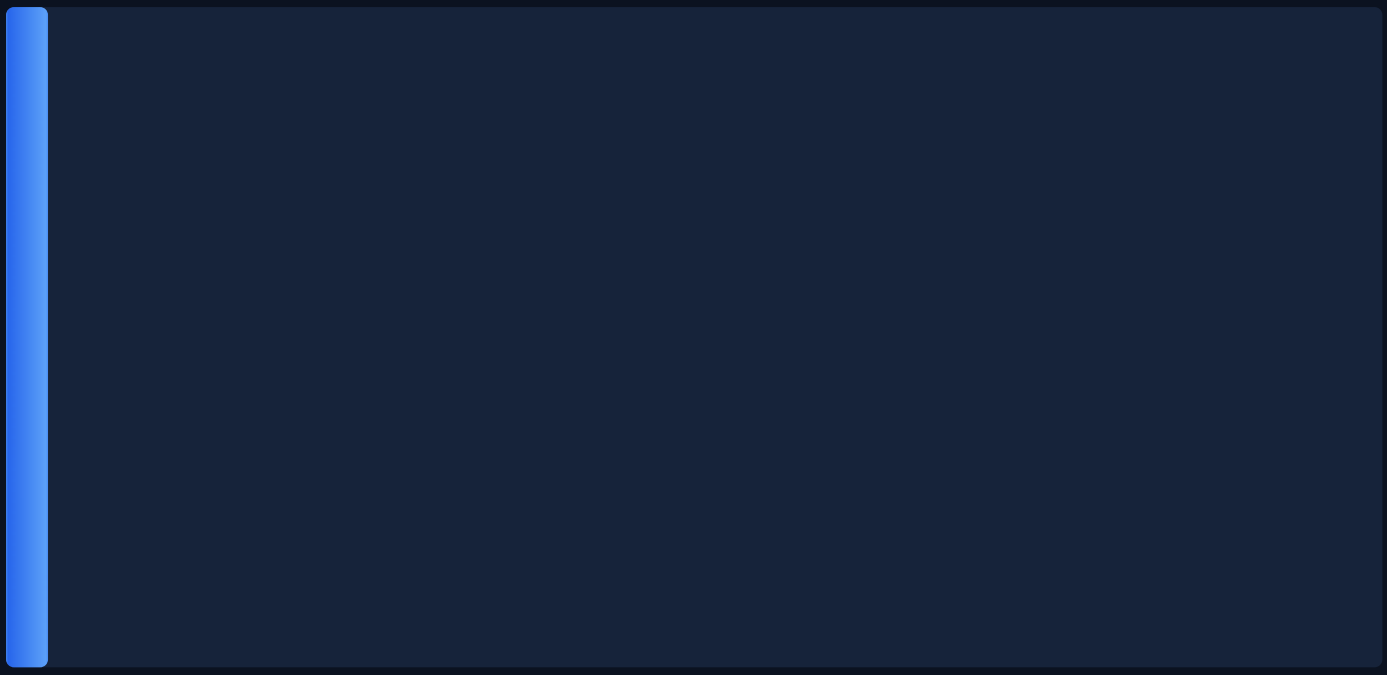
6	28	2	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

40 2mny Website Vulnerability Scanner

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/RanaKhan77/Website-Vulnerability-Scanner

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2	GITHUB STARS
1	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2026	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open-source website protection suite - 200 deterministic scanner modules: XSS, SQLi, SSRF, subdomain takeover, OWASP Top 10, WordPress & AI/LLM surfaces. CVSS-scored evidence, HTML/PDF security reports, continuous attack"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source web vulnerability scanner with 200 deterministic modules: OWASP Top 10, XSS/SQLi/SSRF, subdomain takeover, WordPress and AI/LLM surface checks, CVSS-scored evidence and HTML/PDF reports. Self-hosted via Docker.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams that want evidence-backed, deterministic scanning they can self-host; the open-source alternative to paid scanner SaaS for website attack surfaces. (maintainer's project)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



0	1	0	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

41 Burp Suite Community Edition

portswigger.net/burp/communitydownload

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Burp Suite Community Edition"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the industry-standard intercepting proxy for manual web testing; the free tier is where nearly every bug hunter starts.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web penetration testers as their daily intercepting proxy; the free tier of the industry-standard Burp Suite Professional. (free, proprietary)

42 Nmap

nmap.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Nmap”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the original network mapper: port, service and OS discovery plus the NSE scripting engine for everything from TLS audits to SMB checks.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by virtually every network security auditor on earth; the open standard that commercial scanners built their discovery phases on.

04 Realm Directory

42 curated entries · A–Z

2mny Website Vulnerability Scanner
ACSTIS
aircrack-ng
Bettercap
BloodHound
Burp Suite Community Edition
commix
Dalfox
ettercap
Ghauri
GitTools
goshs
h5i
Impacket
jiraffe
JoomScan
kiterunner
masscan
Metasploit Framework
MITRE Caldera
MobSF
NetExec
Nikto
Nmap
Nuclei
objection
OpenVAS Scanner
osmedeus
OWASP ZAP
Pywerview
Red-Teaming-Toolkit
Responder
RsaCtfTool
RustScan
sqlmap
THC-Hydra
tplmap
Tsunami
wafw00f
wapiti
WhatWeb
WPScan